

ACHIEVE!

HISTORY



World War I

Book 1

Kate Crowhurst



Made for the
Australian Curriculum



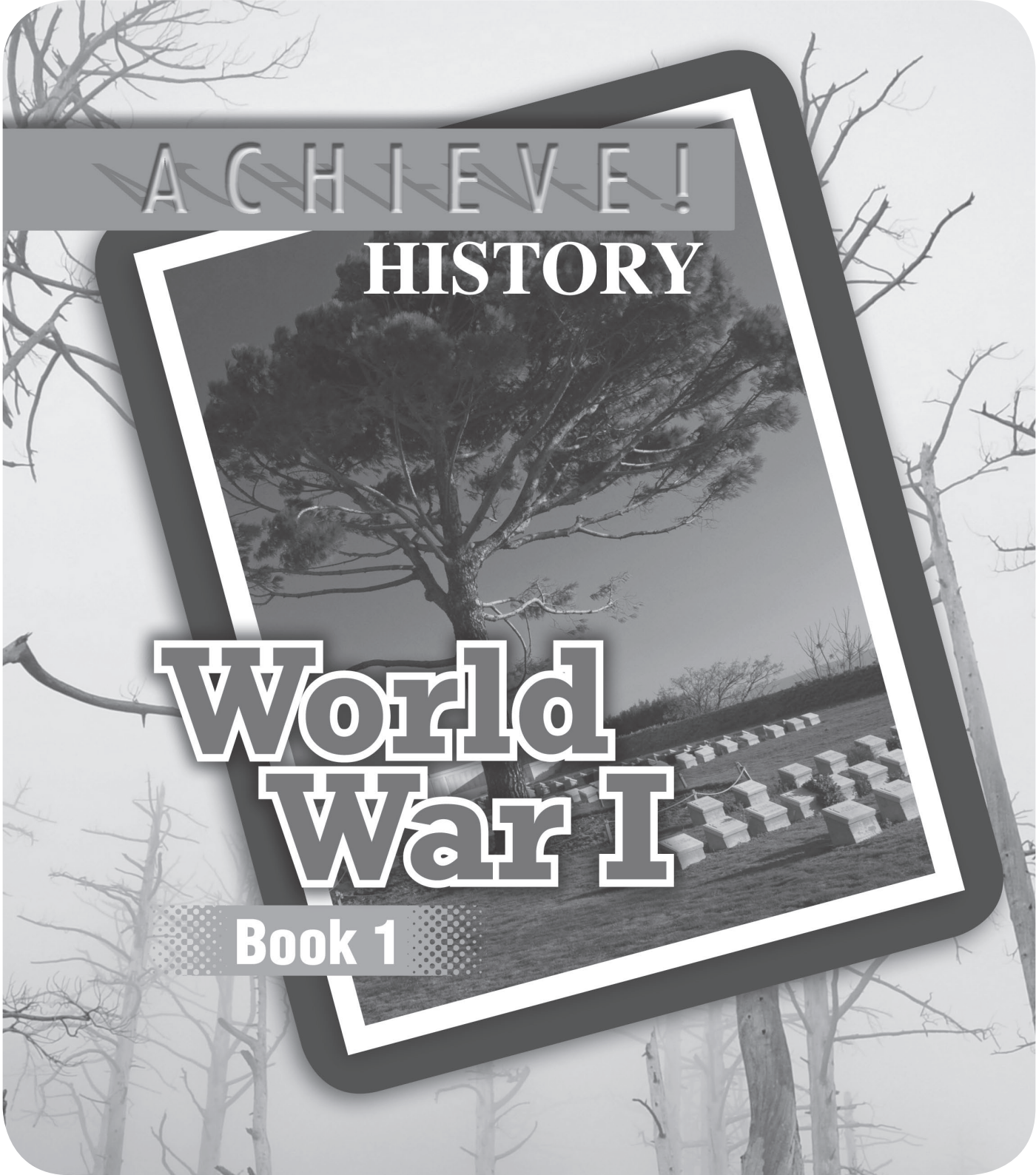
Achieve! History

World War I – Book 1

Features

- ✓ Activities designed to reinforce and enhance literacy skills.
- ✓ Comprehensive Teacher's Notes, providing clear objectives, background information, starter and extension activities.
- ✓ A CD-ROM containing all the pages from the book that can be used on the Interactive Whiteboard, along with Word documents of all work sheets that can be edited to suit the individual needs of students and selected illustrations that can be added to new teacher-created work sheets.
- ✓ Aligned to the Australian Curriculum. See guide below.

The Australian Curriculum alignment Year 9	Unit									
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
An overview of the causes of World War I and the reasons why men enlisted to fight in the war (ACDSEH021)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		
The places where Australians fought and the nature of warfare during World War I, including the Gallipoli campaign (ACDSEH095)										✓
The impact of World War I, with a particular emphasis on Australia (such as the use of propaganda to influence the civilian population, the changing role of women, the conscription debate) (ACDSEH096)								✓	✓	
The commemoration of World War I, including debates about the nature and significance of the Anzac legend (ACDSEH097)										✓
Use chronological sequencing to demonstrate the relationship between events and developments in different periods and places (ACHHS164)					✓					
Use historical terms and concepts (ACHHS165)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓					
Identify and select different kinds of questions about the past to inform historical inquiry (ACHHS166)		✓								
Evaluate and enhance these questions (ACHHS167)				✓						
Identify the origin, purpose and context of primary and secondary sources (ACHHS169)									✓	
Evaluate the reliability and usefulness of primary and secondary sources (ACHHS171)									✓	
Identify and analyse the perspectives of people from the past (ACHHS172)						✓	✓			✓
Select and use a range of communication forms (oral, graphic, written) and digital technologies (ACHHS175)			✓	✓				✓		



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World War I

Book 1

Kate Crowhurst

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Kate Crowhurst is a young and energetic educator with experience across diverse education sectors. A finalist for the United Nations Youth Australia Representative in 2013, she has a passion for making connections between prior knowledge and history.

Kate's education mission is to ensure that language is no barrier to learning and engaging with history. Kate's approach is enhanced by her qualifications and experience in teaching history in tandem with literacy and English as a Second Language. Kate has conducted several workshops for history teachers in Victoria, making history accessible and engaging to all students.

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The *Achieve!* series of History titles has been developed for teachers who require modified, curriculum-focused activities for secondary school students who struggle to read and comprehend regular classroom materials because of poor literacy skills. Many of the pages will also be suitable as supplementary material for regular classes.

World War I – Book 1 looks at the causes of the war, explores main events and studies the effects of the war on Australia. Content includes understanding key historical concepts such as nationalism, alliances, militarism and imperialism. Different perspectives on Australia's involvement are explored, along with the conscription debate, where the war was fought, the use of propaganda and the creation of the Anzac legend. Historical and literacy skills are developed by interpreting primary sources from the era, such as photographs and songs, along with secondary sources. Students develop skills in generating historical questions and communicating in different forms.

The CD-ROM contains all the pages that are featured in the book, as well as a file of selected illustrations that can be used for other work sheets. These documents can be easily edited to suit the individual needs of students.

This book is divided into ten units, containing photocopiable Resource sheets and Activity sheets. This will allow teachers to use the material in a variety of ways. For example, the unit could be taught as a lesson with students in groups of varying sizes. Alternatively, a single Resource sheet and related Activity sheets can be used as support material, for individual homework, assessment or revision.

The teacher's notes provide valuable guidance about using each unit, and contain the following elements.

Objectives – These are the key skills and knowledge learnt through using the work sheets.

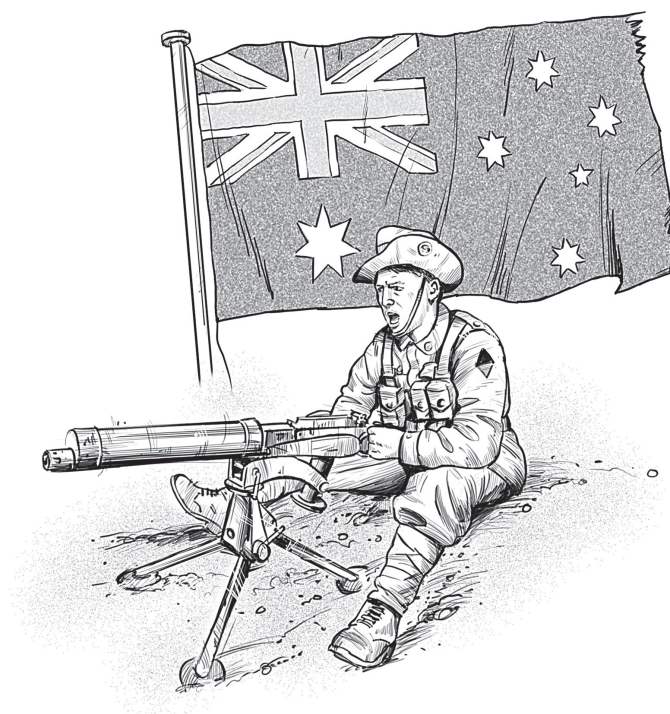
Prior knowledge – This refers to the skills and knowledge required for students to complete the tasks. Some activities are more challenging than others, however, as a rule, students should have a reading comprehension age of six to nine years to be able to attempt the activities.

Background – This section provides additional guidance to help teachers to present a successful lesson. It may include definitions or further background notes about the subject matter.

Starter activity – Warm-up activities are provided to put the content into proper context and to gain student interest and attention.

Resource and Activity work sheets – The Resource sheets do not always contain activities and are used either to stimulate discussion or as a part of the unit's activities. The Activity sheets may be used sequentially or as stand-alone tasks, depending on the needs of the students.

Extension ideas – Additional tasks are suggested to recap the main skills or knowledge taught in the lesson, or to extend, assess or include technology in the lesson.



Objectives

- To understand the causes of World War I
- To learn some key terms and concepts

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge to complete these activities.

Background

World War I was triggered by a climate of fear in Europe. Alliances between countries were a major cause of World War I and divided Europe into two groups – the Triple Alliance and the Triple Entente. It is important that students understand why alliances are created and their impact on other countries in order to understand the climate of insecurity and uncertainty that these generated, and which caused countries across Europe to go to war.

Starter activity

Discuss the basic concepts described in the background material with students. Ask them what they know about Europe and World War I. Introduce them to the terms 'alliance' and 'Europe'. Help students to make a personal connection to the concept of alliances by holding a class discussion using these starter questions:

- What would you do if you saw a fight?
- Would you help your best friend if they got in a fight? Why/why not?
- Is the enemy of your enemy your friend? Why/why not?

Resource and Activity sheets

The first Activity sheet, 'Personal experience of alliances', helps students to identify personal connections to the concept of alliances, which were a major cause of World War I. Encourage students to make connections to their own lives, referencing relevant literature covered in class or recent media stories featuring key alliances.

The Resource sheet, 'Alliances causing conflict', introduces students to the two alliances of World War I and how conflict arose between them. The text also examines how Australia would be affected if the Triple Entente went to war.

The Activity sheet, 'Mapping the alliance divide', examines the geographical divide between the countries in the Triple Alliance and the Triple Entente. Discuss the distance between the countries and how this may have affected their choice of alliance. Draw students' attention to the countries not in an alliance and discuss why these countries may have chosen to stay neutral.

In the Activity sheet, 'The need for alliances', students further explore the alliances and read a case study of the Triple Entente before answering literal, inferential and evaluative questions.

The Activity sheet, 'Summarising alliances', asks students to summarise the content and concepts they have learnt. Discuss the importance of summarising when learning new information, and demonstrate how to identify and use key words in the text.

Extension ideas

Many deals and alliances were made between countries in Europe from 1879 to 1914, ultimately leading to the Triple Alliance and Triple Entente. Students could research these alliances and create a timeline showing the deals formed. This timeline could form the basis of a class discussion.

Examples of alliances to research:

- Dual Alliance (1879)
- Austro-Serbian Alliance (1881)
- The Triple Alliance (1882)
- The Franco-Russian Alliance (1894)
- The Entente Cordiale (1904)
- The Triple Entente (1907)

The following websites could be helpful:

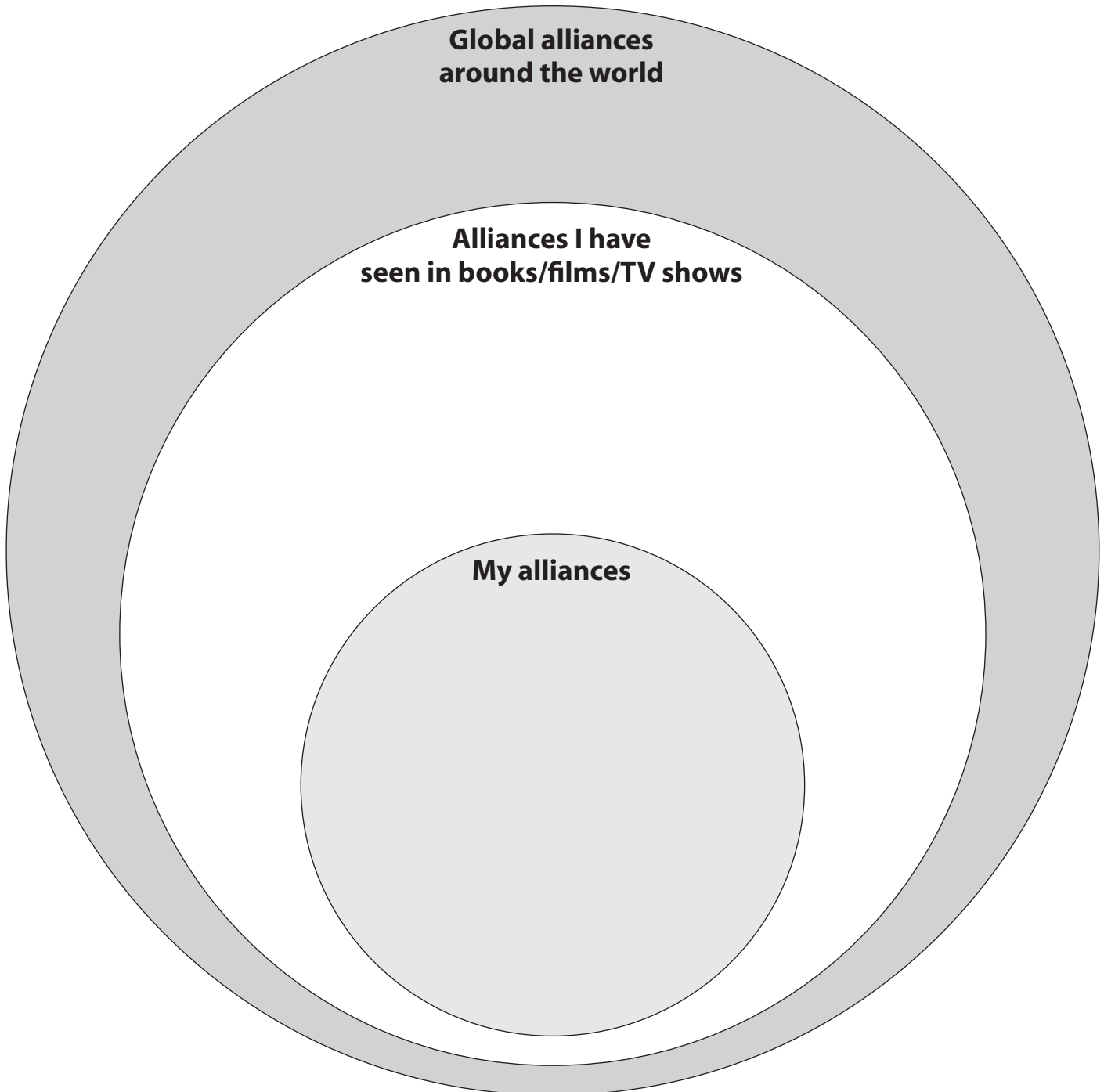
- www.bbc.co.uk/history/worldwars/wwone
- www.greatwar.co.uk/research/ww1-research-index.htm
- www.awm.gov.au

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

Personal experience of alliances

An alliance is a partnership. Alliances can exist between people, groups or countries. You may have alliances in your own life, such as the friendships you have at school, or your teammates on a sports team. Other kinds of alliances include **treaties** between countries.

-  **1** Fill in the alliance circle, listing examples that you have seen.



Alliances causing conflict

World War I (1914–1918) was the first **war** to involve countries in all areas of the world. Millions of people died in the **conflict**.

World War I was a struggle between Europe's great powers. What started as a fight between two countries quickly escalated into full-scale war as other countries joined the fighting to defend their allies. On one side was the **Triple Alliance** (also known as the **Central Powers** because they were in the centre of Europe). This alliance was formed between Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy and the Ottoman Empire (later called Turkey). On the other side was the **Triple Entente** (French for **Allied Powers**). This was an **alliance** between the British Empire, France and Russia (America also joined them later in the fight).

How this affected Australia

Australia was aligned with Britain as a member of the British Commonwealth. If Britain was to go to war, Australia was likely to become involved. Australian soldiers would fight alongside the Triple Entente soldiers. Citizens of Triple Alliance countries living in Australia would also be considered enemies of Australia once Australia joined the fighting.



Mapping the alliance divide

In 1914 Europe was divided into two sides, between the Triple Alliance and the Triple Entente.

- 1 Read the Resource sheet 'Alliances causing conflict'. On the map below, shade the countries using two different colours to show who was in the Triple Alliance and who was in the Triple Entente.



Colour key



Triple Alliance



Triple Entente

The need for alliances

Alliances are agreements made between countries to help each other. This means that the enemy of your friend becomes your enemy, too. For example, Britain and France were allies, so they were united against each other's enemies.

An alliance can:

- provide protection against threats and invasions
- make a country look more powerful
- make other countries (who are not part of the alliance) feel vulnerable and threatened
- mean a country has to join in the fighting if its ally declares war against another country.

The Triple Entente

Since 1879 Germany had been forming alliances with countries across Europe. Britain, France and Russia formed the Triple Entente in 1907 to protect themselves against the increasing power of Germany. As a result of this alliance, an enemy of one country would also become an enemy of the other countries, and if one country declared war, then all countries would go to war.



Use the information about alliances above to answer these questions.

1 What are two people in an alliance called?

2 Why do countries form alliances?

3 How would you feel if your neighbours were forming secret alliances?

4 How could alliances trigger a war?

Summarising alliances

Summarising is taking the information you have read and identifying the main idea. This helps you remember the important information.



- 1** Use the key words listed below to form sentences that summarise (make shorter and describe) the role of alliances in World War I. Sentences should contain 1–3 key words.

Example: When an **alliance** is signed between countries they become **allies**.

alliances

ally

secret

allies

unsure

insecure

enemies

Triple Entente

Triple Alliance

protection

negative

trigger

[illegible]

Objectives

- To understand the causes of World War I
- To learn some key terms and concepts
- To identify different kinds of questions about the past

Prior knowledge

Students should understand what militarism is and how an arms race can create the conditions for war.

Background

World War I was triggered by the rise of militarism in Europe. Countries were building up their armies, navies and air forces in competition with each other, in preparation for an inevitable war in Europe.

Starter activity

Ask students what they know about the military. Introduce them to images and vocabulary associated with the military, such as guns, soldiers and the army. Students should be exposed to images from modern-day wars and 1914-era warfare. Hold a class discussion about developments and features of the military including the nature of warfare in 1914 compared to today.

Resource and Activity sheets

The first Activity sheet, 'Defining militarism', provides students with an understanding of language structure and the use of 'ism' to change a noun to refer to an attitude or belief. This helps students distinguish between the military and the idea of militarism. Students use synonyms to create their own definition of militarism.

The Resource sheet, 'The need for militarism', explains why countries adopted militarism. Through a case study, students identify the competition between countries to increase their military presence.

The Resource sheet, 'Interviewing the British Empire', demonstrates how to ask questions in order to gain more information about a topic or person. It models the 5W and 1H question structure, using an engaging example to encourage class discussion.

In the Activity sheet, 'Interviewing the German Empire', students ask their own 5W and 1H questions about Germany's military strategy in the lead-up to World War I.

The Activity sheet, 'Summarising militarism', helps students summarise their knowledge of militarism by responding to True or False questions about the topic.

Extension ideas

Students could brainstorm what the environment of militarism in early twentieth-century Europe would have been like compared to modern Australian military operations. For example, resources were directed to building arms and munitions rather than spending this money on addressing social issues. Students could then explore one specific difference between military practices in 1914 and today. Questions students could consider include:

- Does this practice still happen in areas of the world today?
- Why do some countries continue to support militarism?
- Would militarism work in modern Australia? Would modern Australian citizens vote for militarism before addressing social issues?

Defining militarism

A country's armed forces are called its **military**. The word **militarism** refers to ideas about the importance of the military and how it should be used.

- Military = the army (a noun or thing)
- Militarism = the belief in and ideas about the military (an idea or attitude)

 **1** Complete the table by writing the original word or its associated belief ('-ism').

Thing (noun)	-ism (noun)	Description
terror	terrorism	The use of terror and violence to threaten others.
military		The belief that a country should have a strong military and use it to defend or promote the country's interests.
	nationalism	A strong love for your country and the belief that it is better than other countries.
imperial		The belief that one country should take over others to increase its power.
	expansionism	The belief that a country should expand (grow) its territory.
	extremism	An extreme, intense belief.
fascist		The belief that a central government should have strict control over the lives of its people.

Militarism is the **belief** that a **country** should have a **strong military** and use this to **defend** or **promote** the country's **interests**.

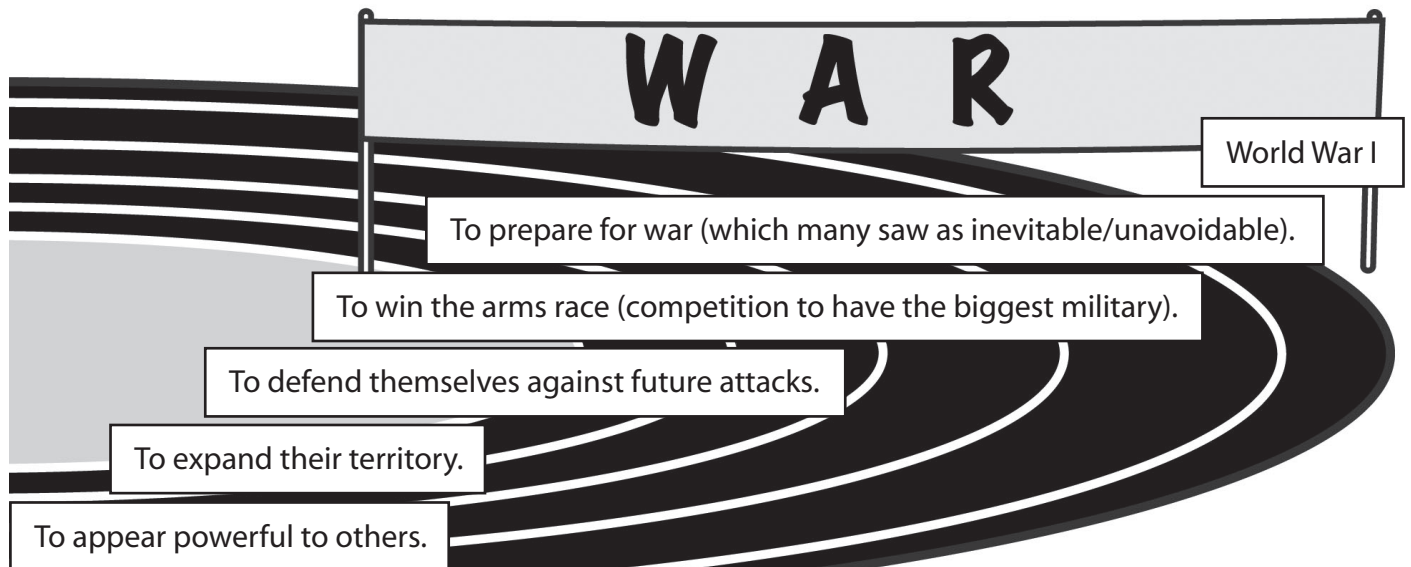
 **2** In your workbook, list synonyms (words with a similar meaning) for the key words that are **bold** in the sentence above.

3 Rewrite the definition of militarism using your synonyms instead of the key words.

Militarism is the _____ that a _____ should have a _____ and use this to _____ or _____ the country's _____.

The need for militarism

Militarism was adopted by many countries in the lead-up to World War I. Countries needed to build strong military forces for a variety of reasons.



Case study: Great Britain vs Germany – the naval race

Great Britain	Germany
is an island; needs a strong navy to defend itself	needs a strong navy to take over other countries under imperialism
has been the dominant naval force since the Battle of Trafalgar in 1805	passed laws in 1898–1900 that dedicated money to building more warships, and named Great Britain as its naval enemy
created HMS <i>Dreadnought</i> in 1906 – the world's fastest and most powerful battleship	started creating dreadnought battleships
By the start of World War I, both Britain and Germany had built up their navies with dreadnought battleships.	
Both countries had put social issues aside to focus on militarism.	
As Britain had more dreadnought battleships when war broke out Britain had a stronger navy.	
Britain was in a better position than Germany to defend itself through the use of its navy.	

Interviewing the British Empire

When many countries are all ruled and controlled by one more-powerful country, this is called an **empire**. Countries under the control of an empire are called colonies. Many countries in Europe had empires. By 1914, the British Empire was the largest empire in the world, ruling over a quarter of the land on Earth. It controlled so much of the world that people would say, 'the sun never sets on the British Empire'. As the world turned, the sun would always be shining on a country that was part of the British Empire. Countries under British control included India and Australia.

We ask questions to find out more information about something. The questions below will help you explore how the size of the British Empire contributed to the outbreak of World War I. The questions follow the 5W and 1H structure.

? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ?

? The 5Ws and 1H are: ?

? • **What?** • **When?** • **Why?** ?

? • **Where?** • **Who?** • **How?** ?

? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ? ?

Question	Example 1	Example 2
WHAT	What is Great Britain's strength?	What are Great Britain's weaknesses?
WHERE	Where is Great Britain?	Where are the countries in the British Empire?
WHEN	When did Great Britain start making treaties?	When did the naval race between Great Britain and Germany start?
WHO	Who are Great Britain's allies?	Who are Great Britain's enemies?
WHY	Why would Great Britain go to war?	Why should Great Britain not go to war?
HOW	How could Great Britain win the war?	How could Great Britain avoid going to war?

Interviewing the German Empire

The German Empire was made up of other countries (colonies) controlled by Germany. Germany expanded its empire in the lead-up to World War I, in an attempt to rival Great Britain, who had the largest empire. Although it wasn't as large as the British Empire, by 1913 the German Empire included areas which are today part of France, Russia and Poland.

-  **1** Read the Resource sheet, 'Interviewing the British Empire'. Using the 5W and 1H questions, create a list of questions about the expansion of Germany's military in 1913.

Question	Example	Question 1	Question 2
WHAT	What kind of weapon are you making most of?		
WHERE	Where do you make the guns for your army?		
WHEN	When did you start the arms race?		
WHO	Who is the enemy you fear the most?		
WHY	Why did you start believing in militarism?		
HOW	How do you fund militarism?		

Summarising militarism

Summarising is a way of describing a lot of information briefly. This means there is less information to read, and makes it easier to remember.

-  **1** Read the statements below and decide whether each is true or false. The first one has been done for you.

	True	False
Only one country in Europe believed in militarism.		✓
Militarism created a friendly, peaceful environment in Europe.		
Militarism made World War I unavoidable.		
There was a naval arms race between Germany and France.		
Militarism refers to a country's belief in the importance of a strong military.		
Great Britain was an island country so it needed a large navy to defend itself.		
Great Britain created HMS <i>Dreadnought</i> in 1806.		
Germany was an island country.		
Militarism is a noun that refers to a belief or attitude.		
The military includes the navy, army and air force of a particular country.		
The military only refers to the army of a country.		
Britain controlled one-eighth of the land on Earth in 1914.		
In 1914 the German Empire was the largest in the world.		
India and Australia were part of the British Empire.		
Poland was part of the British Empire.		
Germany and Great Britain were in a naval arms race.		
Germany wanted to be as powerful as Great Britain.		
Germany was jealous of and threatened by the British Empire.		

Objectives

- To understand the causes of World War I
- To learn key terms and concepts
- To explore different forms of communication

Prior knowledge

Students would benefit from studying militarism in Unit 2 before undertaking this unit in order to understand the militaristic context that drives people to fight for their country.

Background

World War I was fought for many years because of growing nationalism in Europe. Nationalism encouraged citizens to sacrifice their lifestyles and safety in order to work for, fight for and defend their country. It is important that students understand how nationalism benefited European leaders and how this was generated in order to comprehend the strong nationalism that drove nations to compete against each other rather than working together.

Starter activity

Discuss nationalism with students. Introduce them to the idea of having loyalty to a sports club, their family or friends. Highlight how loyalties can both unite and divide people.

To demonstrate this, first unite the class by explaining that they all go to the same school, then divide up the students according to their sporting loyalties or the areas in which they live. This physically shows the students how their loyalties have the potential to unite or divide them.

Resource and Activity sheets

In the Activity sheet, 'Defining nationalism', students write their own definition of nationalism. As an extension, students could write these definitions without the scaffolding support. Before commencing the activity, remind students what antonyms and synonyms are.

The second Activity sheet, 'Why promote nationalism?', explores the advantages that nationalism provides to a nation's leaders. Students illustrate each advantage before matching them with an explanation of the benefit to leaders.

The Activity sheet, 'How to create nationalism', explains how a country's national symbols are used to promote nationalism, using national symbols of Australia and Great Britain as examples. Extend the activity by playing Australian national songs or showing physical examples of Australian national symbols for students to interact with.

In the Activity sheet, 'Living with nationalism', students are encouraged to think about the personal experiences of people who lived through World War I. Students describe what living with nationalism would look like, feel like and sound like. As an extension, students could use these words to write a letter describing these experiences to a friend.

The Activity sheet, 'Summarising alliances', gives students practice at summarising what they have learned about nationalism. They are shown how bullet points can be used to briefly summarise information in point form, making it easier to read.

Extension ideas

Students could write a diary entry from the point of view of a citizen living in one of the countries that fought in World War I. They could research the allies and enemies of that country and identify the citizen's contribution to the nation, such as undertaking food rationing, working in a factory, signing up for the army reserves, etc.

Possible questions to explore include:

- What sacrifices are you making for your country?
- Why are you making these sacrifices?
- How do you feel towards your country's allies?
- How do you feel towards your country's enemies?
- What would you do if your country declared war on its enemies?

After writing their diary entries students could also conduct a role-play as their adopted citizens.

Defining nationalism

Nationalism is a feeling of devotion towards your nation (country). Most people like the country where they were born or live. Nationalism is an even stronger feeling. It refers to the belief that one's country is better than all others. Some people would even go to war to support their country.



-  **1** Find a synonym and antonym for each of the key words listed below.

Word	Synonym	Antonym	Word	Synonym	Antonym
patriot			enemy		
love			fight		
ally			sacrifice		

- 2** Use the synonyms and antonyms you found above to complete the definitions below.

- a** Being a **patriot** or a _____ means being loyal to your country. The opposite of this is being a _____.
- b** Nationalism requires you to show that you **love** or _____ your country. The opposite of this is showing that you _____ your country.
- c** Nationalism means you must also support an **ally** or _____ of your country. The opposite of this is supporting a/an _____.
- d** Loving your country means that you must *not* support an **enemy** or _____ of your country. The opposite of this is supporting a/an _____ of your country.
- e** Strong nationalism means people are willing to **fight** or _____ to defend their country. The opposite of this is _____.
- f** You sometimes need to **sacrifice** or _____ things to prove you love your country. The opposite of this is _____.

Why promote nationalism?

Nationalism means that people are willing to support their country and its rulers or government. This means that the leader of the country will have:

- people who are willing to be soldiers in their army
- workers to make guns in their arms factories
- more freedom to make unpopular decisions (people will be willing to make sacrifices)
- increased national security (more people will want to defend their country)
- support for sacrifices such as rationing and conscription.

 **1** The table below lists the advantages of nationalism for leaders. Draw a symbol of each advantage in the space provided.

2 The explanations provided are in the wrong order. Draw a line to match each advantage with the correct explanation of how this helps a country's leader.

Symbol	Advantage	Explanation
	Soldiers for their army	Making more guns means you can increase the size of your army quickly.
	A workforce to make guns in their arms factories	You will be able to defend your country against attacks.
	More freedom to make unpopular decisions	You can confidently invade other countries.
	Increased national security (more people will want to defend their country)	You can ask people to go through more difficult times to support the country.
	Support for sacrifices such as rationing and conscription	You can make unpopular decisions without worrying about losing votes.

How to create nationalism

Nationalism can be developed through the use of signs or symbols. To make a country seem more important to its people, the leaders of a country will use symbols and icons. They promote these symbols so that people see them often and become attached to them. This helps develop loyalty and passion.

-  **1** The table below lists symbols that can be used to promote nationalism. Draw a picture of each symbol (use the suggestions to help you). You may wish to choose symbols from another country that fought in World War I.

Symbol	Symbols of Australia	Symbols of Great Britain
National flag	Suggestion: Australian flag	Suggestion: British flag
National animals	Suggestion: Kangaroo	Suggestion: Lion
National flower	Suggestion: Wattle flower	Suggestion: English rose

- 2** Other symbols you might be familiar with include national colours, national sports and national celebrities/heroes (both past and present). Draw these symbols in your workbook for both Australia and another country.

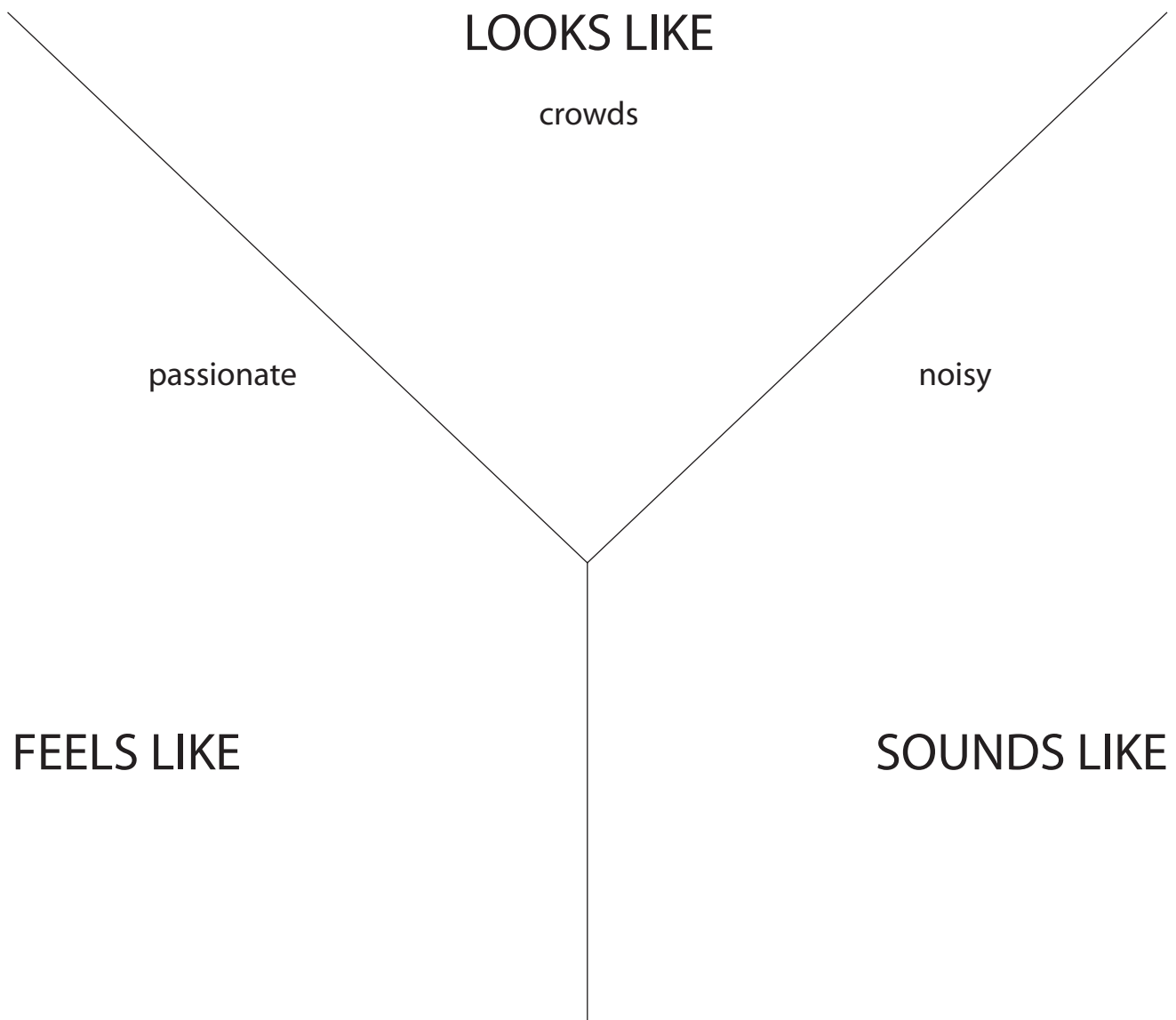
Living with nationalism

Nationalism is a powerful movement that can cause people to support, fight and die in wars such as World War I.

Imagine you are living in a time of strong nationalism in your country. What does this nationalism:

- look like?
- feel like?
- sound like?

 **1** Write key words to describe what nationalism looks like, feels like and sounds like. Some examples have been provided.



Summarising nationalism

Summarising information makes it short, punchy and easy to understand. One way to summarise is to put information into short bullet points.

The following paragraph describes nationalism. It looks like a huge chunk of information!

Nationalism is a feeling of devotion towards your nation (country). Nationalism is a strong feeling – some people love their country so much they would even die in a war to defend it. Nationalism means people are willing to support the leaders of their country and make sacrifices. This devotion presents many advantages for the country's leader. For example, they have more soldiers for their army, a workforce to make guns in their arms factories, more freedom to make unpopular decisions, greater national security and people more willing to make sacrifices such as rationing food. Leaders can use the symbols of a country to promote nationalism by emphasising how important their country is. This makes people feel more loyal towards their country. Examples of symbols include the national flag, colours and animals. At the time of World War I, nationalism was growing stronger in lots of countries, which meant people were willing to fight for, work for and defend their country against its enemies.

 **1** Summarise the information above in short bullet points. An example has been provided.

- Nationalism means devotion to your country.

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Objectives

- To understand the causes of World War I
- To learn key terms and concepts
- To compose effective questions about the past

Prior knowledge

As many activities refer to militarism concepts, it would be useful for students to have completed the Militarism unit before completing this unit.

Background

The lead-up to World War I saw many countries take over other nations in order to build an empire. This gave them power all over the world. It is important that students understand how imperialism allows countries to dominate others, and how this caused colonies such as Australia to be drawn into a war that was primarily fought in Europe.

Starter activity

Discuss the geography of Europe and the world in 1914. Ask students to choose different empires and colour a map to show the areas of land that those empires controlled. Ask students how they think those areas of land were taken over and why.

Examples of empires in 1914 include:

- the British Empire
- the German Empire
- the Ottoman Empire
- the Austro-Hungarian Empire.

Resource and Activity sheets

The first Activity sheet, 'Defining imperialism', provides students with vocabulary support to describe imperialism. Students should first find synonyms for the original words before looking them up in a dictionary.

The Resource sheet, 'How to build an empire', explores the advantages of having a strong empire. Have students explore Australia as an example, encouraging them to debate whether Australia needed to fight in World War I and to question why it did so.

The Activity sheet, 'Europe's empires', tests students' knowledge of imperialism by asking questions about the topic.

The Activity sheet, 'How to remember the causes of World War I', enables students to summarise the four causes they have learnt about so far by associating each cause with a visual. Ask students to explain the relevance of the images to each cause and why the images have been chosen.

In the Activity sheet, 'Answering questions about the MAIN causes', students write questions they have about the MAIN causes of World War I using the 5W and 1H structure. They then swap questions with another student and try to answer their peer's questions. Students can access additional materials to answer these questions if required.

Extension ideas

- Students could apply different summarising techniques (bullet points, finding key words, etc) to the different passages in the unit.
- Students could enhance the information by providing synonyms to replace the original words used.
- Students could write a news article predicting what may have happened to each of the empires after the war.

Defining imperialism

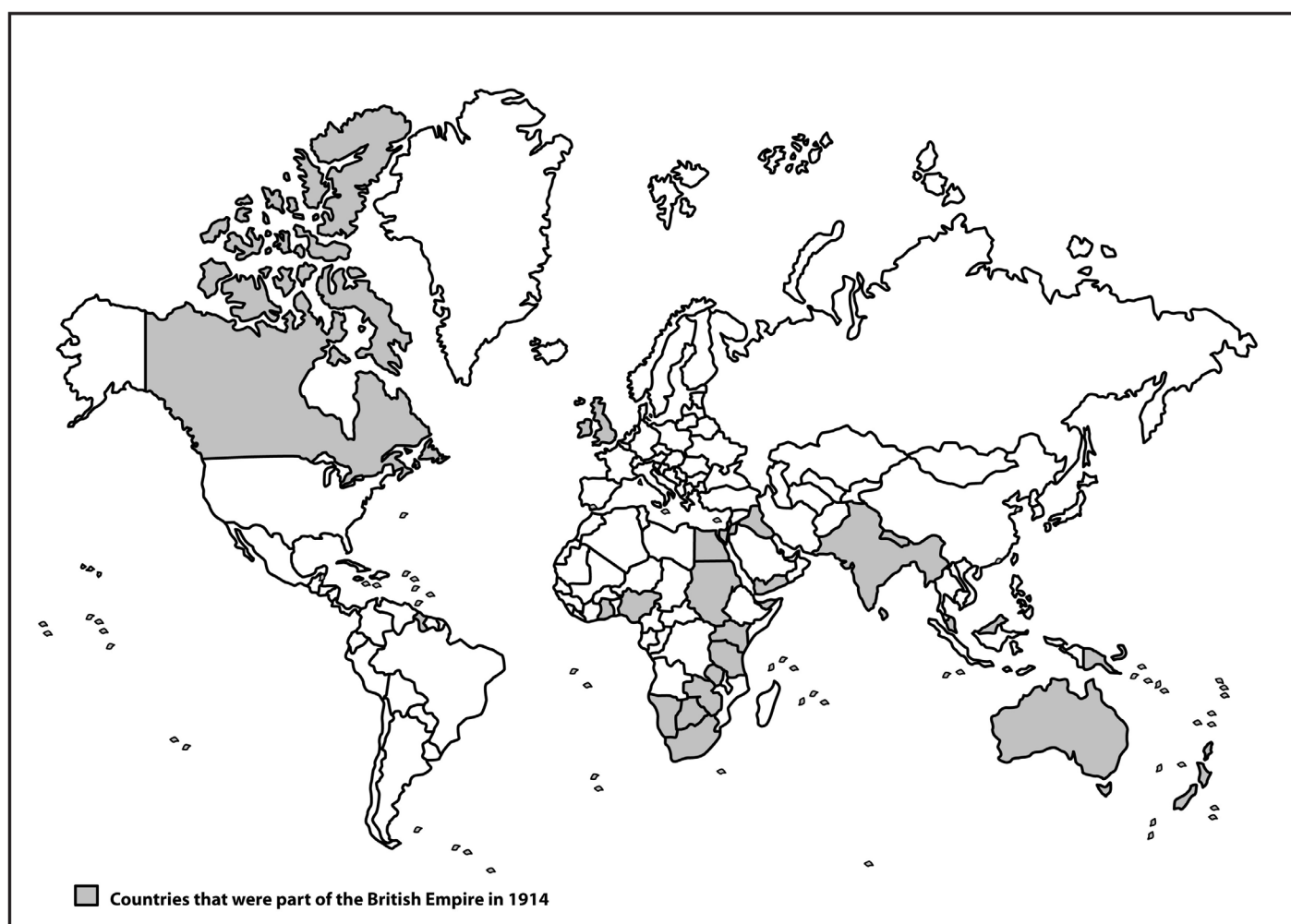
Imperialism refers to the practice of taking over other countries. Countries do this to gain more power. Their enemies can see how much power they have and will be less likely to attack them.

-  **1** The words listed below will help you understand imperialism. Find a **synonym** for each of the key words.
- 2** Write a definition for the original word (in your own words). Refer to a dictionary if you need to.

Word	Synonym	Definition
land		
power		
imperial		
imperialist		
control		
rule		
empire		
domination		
authority		
colony		

How to build an empire

The British Empire was a case study in how to build an empire. Over a number of years Britain had used its powerful navy to take over several other countries. By 1914 the British Empire ruled over a quarter of the land on Earth, despite being an island country. This gave Britain power all over the world, allowing it to influence other countries, control their decisions and use their resources to further expand the empire.



Britain claimed Australia's land and people in 1770, making it part of the British Empire. Because it was such a large area, Australia was divided into smaller areas of land called colonies. This made it easier for Britain to control the land and the people.

Even when the colonies were united under Federation and Australia became one single country it still remained under British control. Many Australians felt connected to the British Empire. They felt strong loyalty towards Britain, which they saw as the motherland, and would defend it in a fight. This is why Australia joined the fighting in World War I in order to defend the British Empire.

Europe's empires

 Read the Resource sheet, 'How to build an empire', then answer the following questions.

1 What is a synonym of 'domination'?

2 Define 'power'.

3 What is a colony?

4 Why would Australia join Britain in a war?

5 Was Britain the strongest empire in 1914? Why?

6 How would other empires feel about Britain in 1914?

7 Would you start a war with Britain in 1914? Give reasons for your answer.

8 Why would building an empire get easier as the empire expanded?

How to remember the causes of World War I

In order to remember the four causes of World War I we use the acronym MAIN. An acronym is a word formed from the first letter of other words.

- **M** – **M**ilitarism (military power)
- **A** – **A**lliances (friendships between countries)
- **I** – **I**mperialism (taking over other countries)
- **N** – **N**ationalism (loving your own country)

Another way to remember the four causes of World War I is to visualise them.



1 Draw a picture to represent each cause of World War I.

Militarism

Alliances

Imperialism

Nationalism

Asking questions about the MAIN causes

- 1 Following the 5W and 1H structure from the Activity sheet, 'How to remember the causes of World War I', write six questions about each of the MAIN causes of World War I.
- 2 Swap your questions with a partner. Try to answer their questions.

Question	M Militarism	A Alliances	I Imperialism	N Nationalism
WHAT	<i>Example: What is militarism?</i>			
WHERE	<i>Example: Where were armies stationed?</i>			
WHEN	<i>Example: When did militarism start?</i>			
WHO	<i>Example: Who won the naval arms race?</i>			
WHY	<i>Example: Why did militarism cause World War I?</i>			
HOW	<i>Example: How did militarism lead to fighting in Europe?</i>			

Objectives

- To understand the causes of World War I
- To learn key terms and concepts
- To learn how to use different forms of communication
- To learn how to use chronological sequencing

Prior knowledge

Students need to have prior knowledge of the causes of World War I (see Units 1–4). It would also be helpful for students to have completed the summarising activities in each of these units.

Background

Students will be aware of the causes of World War I from their study of Units 1–4. This unit will help students express their knowledge by planning and writing an essay about the causes of World War I. It is important that students are able to express their knowledge in writing, as this will be a requirement of students studying history at a senior level. Students also need to be able to sequence events chronologically on a timeline in order to better understand the chain of events that led to World War I.

Starter activity

Introduce the subject of essay writing. Have students move into small groups, and appoint a scribe for each group. Give students some questions about essays for them to discuss, then have each group share their responses with the class.

Questions could include:

- What makes a good essay?
- What makes a good history essay?
- What do you need to add to a history essay which would make it different to an English essay?

Resource and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet, 'Constructing essays', poses questions to ensure that students fully understand set essay questions. A connection is drawn between essay construction and house construction in order to help students see essay construction as an achievable process, rather than a formal task.

The Activity sheet, 'Essay planning', helps students to plan their essays by answering questions about each set paragraph.

The Activity sheet, 'Writing paragraphs', helps students develop their bullet points into full sentences. As an extension, students could then use their full sentences to write a complete essay.

In the Resource sheet, 'Mapping events in a timeline', students observe two examples of timelines, demonstrating the rules of how timelines work.

The Activity sheet, 'World War I trigger timeline', gives students the opportunity to put the timeline rules into action. Students view the events leading up to World War I that triggered the war. Make sure students understand how the MAIN causes created the environment for war.

Extension ideas

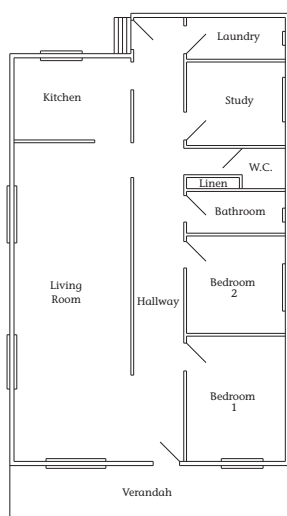
- Working as individuals or in small groups or pairs, students could plan and write other essays about the causes of the war. For example: What was the most important cause of World War I? Was World War I avoidable?

Constructing essays

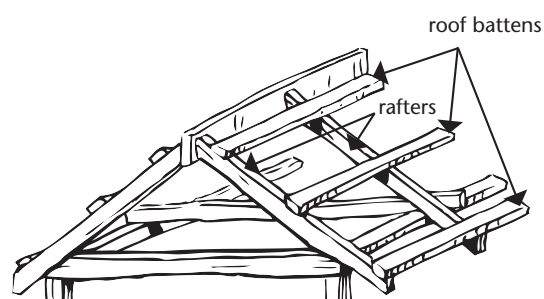
An essay is an effective way of demonstrating what you know about history. Essays are easier if you view them as a thing to be constructed, rather than written. One way to visualise this is to compare essay construction to house construction.



Both need a foundation
Essay question



Both need planning
Essay plan



Both need extra detail
Examples (evidence)

Just as a builder first meets with the land owners to find out what they want them to build, you need to first work out what an essay question is asking you to do. This is unpacking a question. One way to do this is to find synonyms for the key words used in the question. This allows you to explain the question in a different way.

Essay question: What causes led to World War I?

 **1** Find three synonyms for each of the following key words.

	Synonym 1	Synonym 2	Synonym 3
causes			
led			

2 Rephrase the essay question in three different ways, using the synonyms you found above.

- _____
- _____
- _____

Essay planning

The next step is to plan your essay. An essay is made up of three sections:

- introduction – a paragraph to introduce the essay
- body – several paragraphs explaining your answer to the essay question
- conclusion – a paragraph to conclude (finish) your essay.

 **1** Fill in the essay planner below. Your responses will form the framework of your essay.

Paragraph topic	What you need to include	Your plan
Introduction	• What is the essay going to be about?	•
Militarism	• What is militarism? • Example of militarism in WWI • How militarism caused WWI	• Belief in strong militaries • Naval race • All countries built up armies
Alliances	• What are alliances? • Example of alliances in WWI • How alliances caused WWI	
Imperialism	• What is imperialism? • Example of imperialism in WWI • How imperialism caused WWI	
Nationalism	• What is nationalism? • Example of nationalism in WWI • How nationalism caused WWI	
Conclusion	• What has the essay been about?	

Writing paragraphs

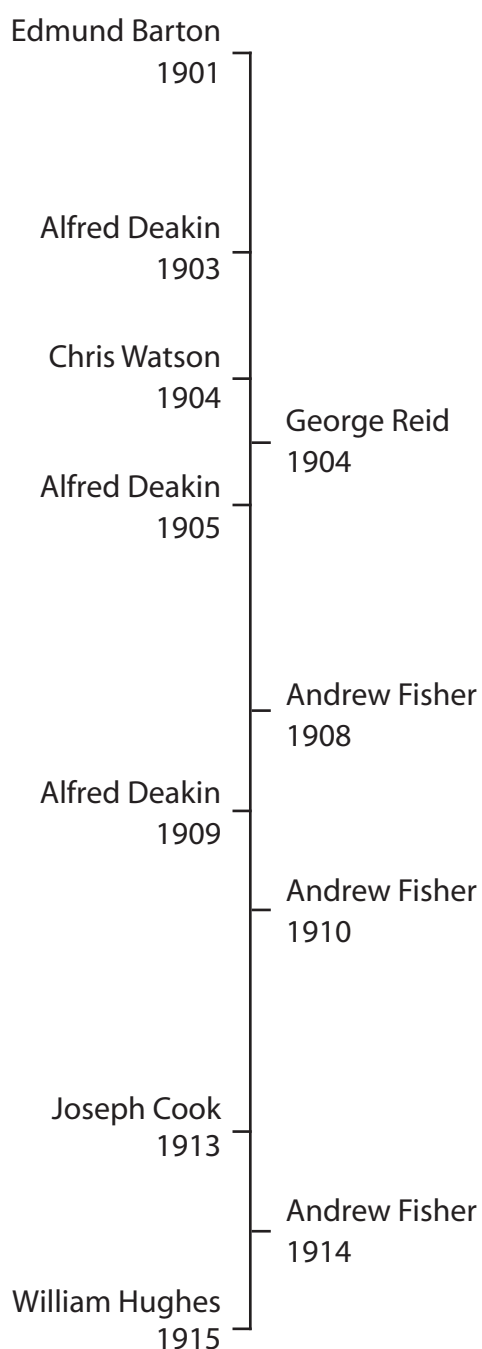
-  Complete the Activity sheet, 'Essay planning', then write your notes into full sentences in the table below. The example for militarism has been done for you.

Introduction
Militarism
Militarism is the belief that countries should have strong militaries so they can defend themselves and take over other countries. An example is the naval race between Great Britain and Germany. Militarism caused World War I because all countries were building up their armies and preparing for war.
Alliances
Imperialism
Nationalism
Conclusion

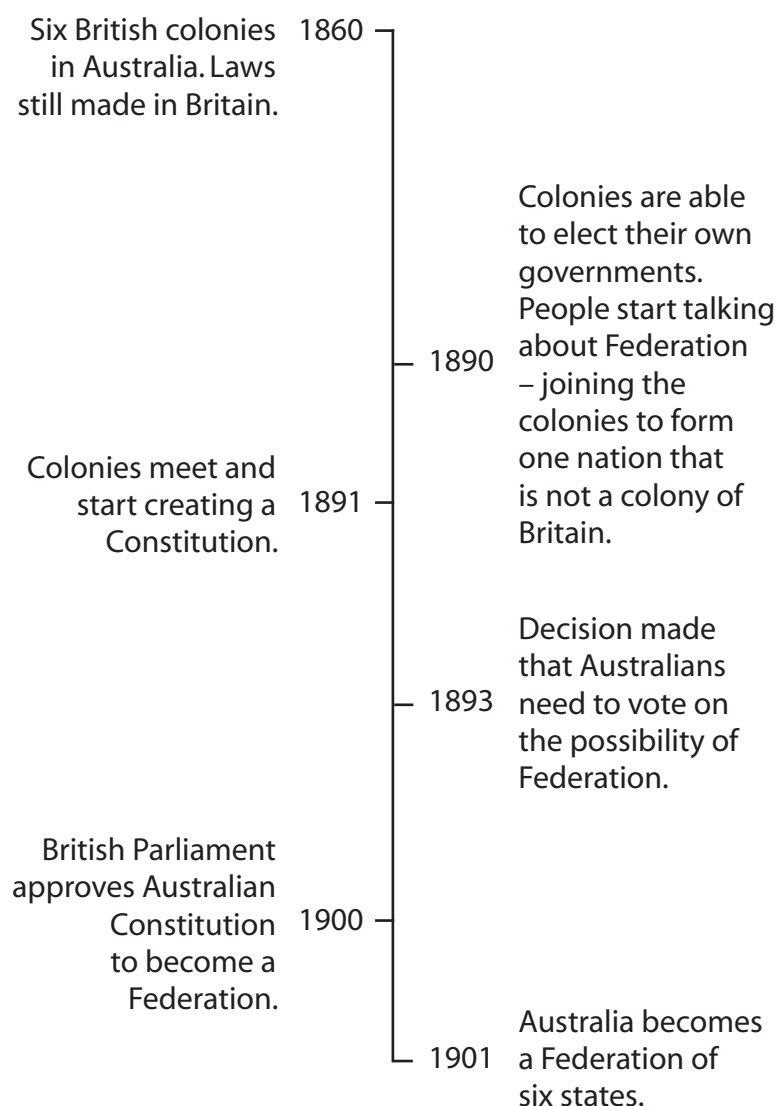
Mapping events on a timeline

To understand how historical events took place, we need to sort them into the order in which they happened. This is called **chronological order**. We can sort events by date and display them on a **timeline**. Below are two examples of timelines that show the sequence (order) of historical events.

Australian Prime Ministers from 1901–1915



Australia's journey to Federation



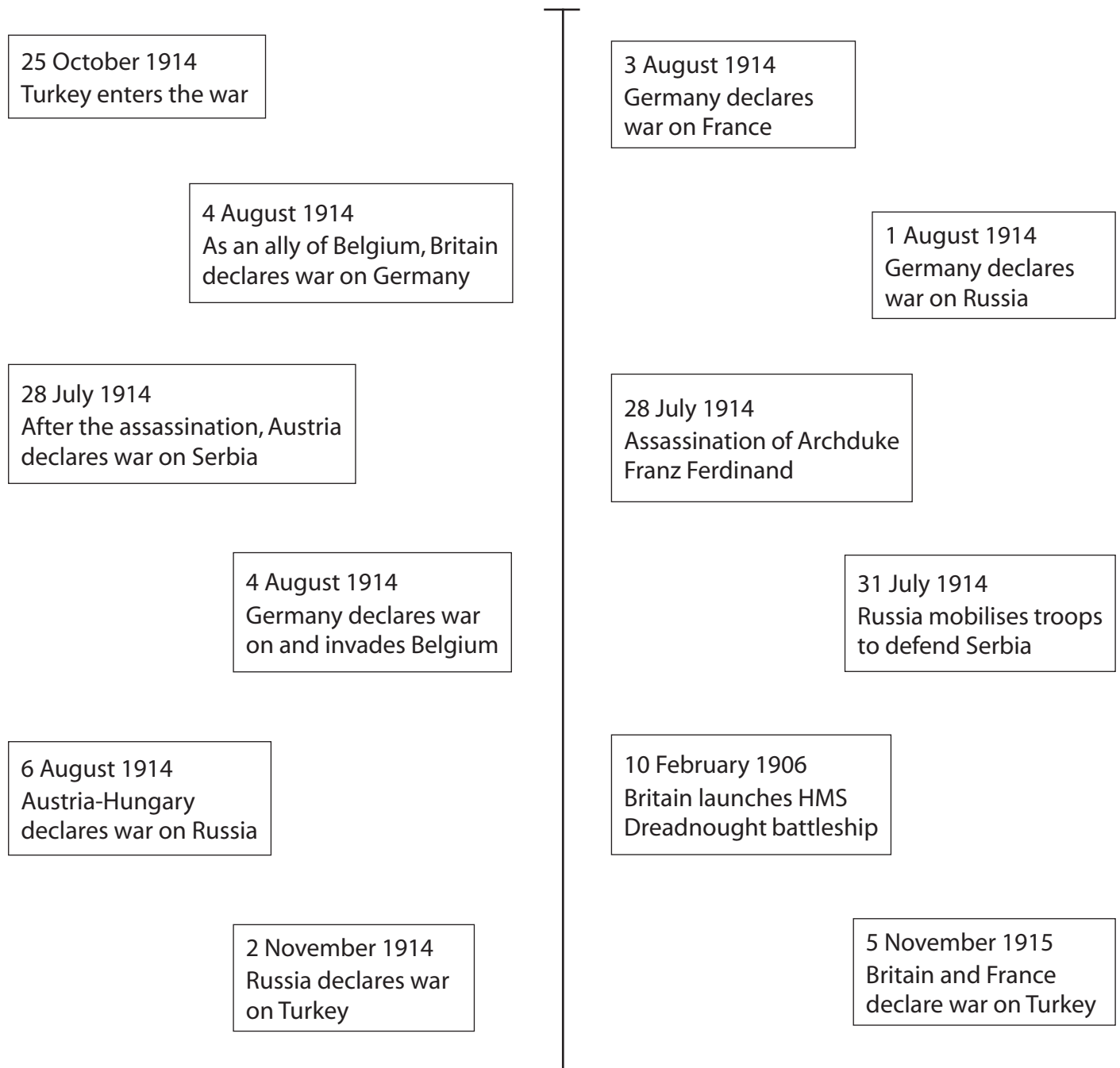
Rules for creating a timeline:

- All events are given a date.
- Each event and date is marked and labelled on the timeline.
- Events must be sorted by the date on which they happened.

World War I trigger timeline

World War I was triggered (started) by several events. While the MAIN causes of World War I created the conditions for war, the events listed below actually triggered the war.

-  **1** Draw lines matching the events to their correct position on the timeline.



- 2** What was the most significant (important) trigger of World War I? Why?

Objectives

- To understand the causes of World War I
- To understand different perspectives

Prior knowledge

Students should be familiar with European geography and imperialism in order to understand the motivations behind the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand.

Background

While the MAIN (militarism, alliances, imperialism and nationalism) causes of World War I created the conditions for war, a spark or trigger was needed to start it. This unit looks at that trigger – the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand. This completes the overview of the causes of World War I and helps students understand how the trigger led to war, which was inevitable given the climate in Europe at the time.

Starter activity

Have students predict what will trigger World War I by holding a class discussion. Questions you could ask include:

- How likely is the war?
- Are militarism, alliances, imperialism and nationalism enough to start the war?
- Who will start the war?

Encourage students to consider the idea of a trigger – something to start the war Europe had been conditioned to expect.

Resource and Activity sheets

The first Activity sheet, 'Language of triggers', demonstrates language associated with triggers so that students can understand how World War I started.

The Resource sheet, 'The assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand', gives students the background on the assassination that triggered the outbreak of war.

The Activity sheet, 'Crime scene report', helps students identify key facts about the assassination in order to understand its significance.

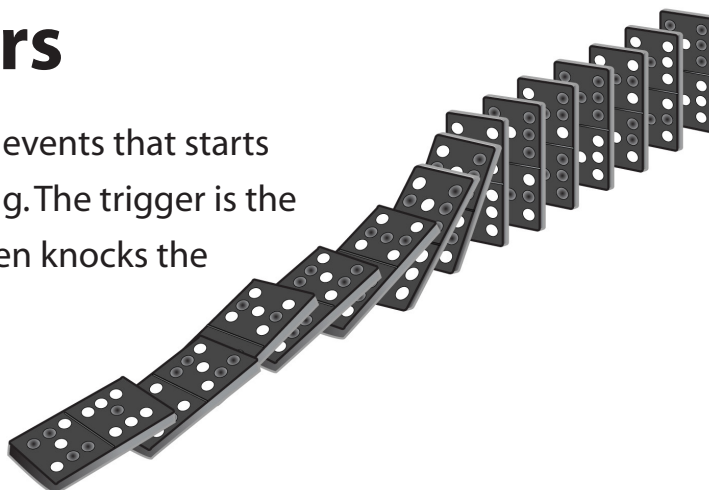
The Activity sheet, 'Viewpoints of World War I (1)', encourages students to consider the viewpoints of both sides. The Activity sheet, 'Viewpoints of World War I (2)', then encourages students to identify similarities and differences between the two sides and their role in starting the war. Students complete a Venn diagram using the information from the previous Activity sheet. They then articulate this information in full sentences using the sentence starters provided.

Extension ideas

- Having compared the viewpoints of both sides in the lead-up to World War I, students could now adopt one of these viewpoints and write a persuasive essay or speech to convince others that their side is right.
- Students could participate in a class debate, arguing that their chosen side was justified in engaging in World War I.

Language of triggers

A trigger is an action, process or series of events that starts something. Think of a line of dominoes falling. The trigger is the force that pushes the first domino, which then knocks the next over, and then the next, and so on.



1 Circle the synonyms of 'trigger' in the five sentences below.

- Militarism can start when countries form armies to fight.
- When people are extremely devoted to their country, this can activate a feeling of nationalism.
- Imperialism causes a power imbalance when countries take over other nations.
- Alliances begin when countries make agreements or friendships to support each other against enemies.
- The climate in Europe before World War I was so tense, all it took was one action to prompt the outbreak of war.

2 Use each synonym for 'trigger' in a sentence. The first one has been done for you.

Synonym	Sentence
activate	It only took one harsh word to activate the argument that had been brewing.
set off	
cause	
generate	
start	
prompt	
initiate	

The assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand

World War I was begun by a literal trigger – the trigger of a gun, when Archduke Franz Ferdinand was **assassinated** on 28 June 1914. His murder is called an assassination because it was for political reasons, and because he was a public figure.

The victim

Archduke Franz Ferdinand was heir to the empire of Austria-Hungary, which had taken over Bosnia in 1908.

The assassin

The assassin was from a group of Serbian **terrorists** who felt that Bosnia should be part of Serbia rather than Austria-Hungary.

The scene of the murder

The murder took place when the Archduke visited Bosnia and Herzegovina to inspect his army on 28 June 1914.

The crime scene

There were two crime scenes and two attempts at the assassination. The first attempt was a grenade attack, which injured the Archduke's attendants but left him unharmed. The Archduke was on his way to hospital to visit those injured in the first attack when he was **ambushed**. He and his pregnant wife were both shot and killed.

The result

A month after the Archduke's assassination, Austria-Hungary declared war against Serbia. This was the beginning of World War I.



Crime scene report

- 1 Complete the crime scene report below with details about the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand.

Crime committed:	
Date of murder:	
Victim 1 name:	
Victim 1 nationality:	
Victim 1 profession:	
Victim 2 name:	
Relationship between Victim 1 and Victim 2:	
Cause of death:	
Location of death:	
Description of attacker:	
Attacker's motive (reason for attack):	

Reporting officer's statement: *(Imagine you were a police officer protecting the Archduke on his visit. What did you see/hear/feel/do **before, during** and **after** the murder?)*

- Before
- During
- After

Viewpoints of World War I (1)

When the Serbian attacker pulled the trigger and assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand, this also served as the trigger for war. Soon after the assassination, Austria-Hungary declared war on Serbia. Serbia was allied with Russia, a member of the Triple Entente. However, Austria-Hungary was a member of the Triple Alliance. These alliances meant that what started as a small conflict quickly escalated into a world war.

Triple Entente

-  **1** Pick a member of the Triple Entente: Great Britain, France or Russia. Answer these questions from the point of view of that country. The first one has been done for you.

Question	Response
Example: Who are your allies?	Great Britain: My allies are France and Russia.
Who are you fighting against?	
Why are you fighting in this war?	

Triple Alliance

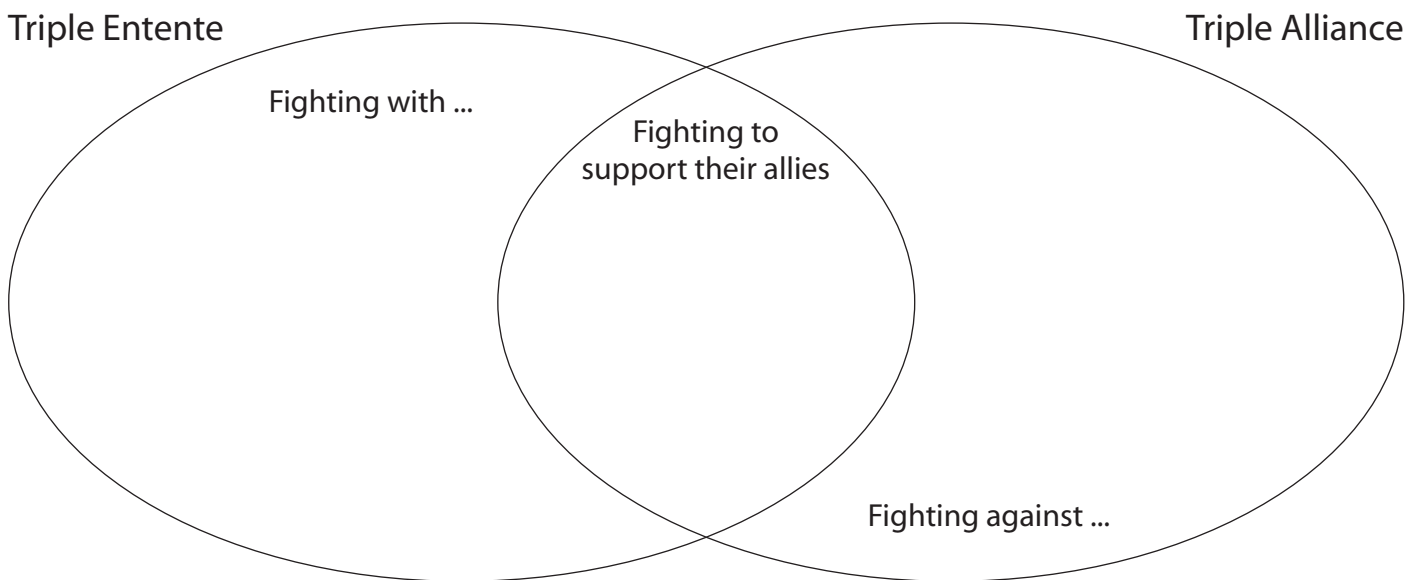
- 2** Pick a member of the Triple Alliance: Germany, Austria-Hungary or Italy (they were later joined by the Ottoman Empire). Answer these questions from the point of view of that country. The first one has been done for you.

Question	Response
Example: Who are your allies?	Germany: My allies are Austria-Hungary and Italy.
Who are you fighting against?	
Why are you fighting in this war?	

Viewpoints of World War I (2)

In order to fully understand both sides of the story it is important to compare both viewpoints. One way to do this is by putting information into a Venn diagram.

-  **1** Complete the Activity sheet, 'Viewpoints of World War I (1)', then use the information to fill out the Venn diagram below. One example has been filled in for you.
- Information that only relates to the Triple Entente goes on the left.
 - Information that relates to both the Triple Entente and the Triple Alliance goes in the middle.
 - Information that only relates to the Triple Alliance goes on the right.



2 Using the sentence starters below, write the information above in full sentences to show the similarities and differences between the viewpoints.

a Similarities between the viewpoints of the Triple Entente and the Triple Alliances are ____

b Unlike the Triple Alliance, the Triple Entente _____

c The Triple Alliance was different to the Triple Entente because _____

Objectives

- To understand different perspectives
- To investigate the different attitudes towards World War I in Australia

Prior knowledge

Students should be familiar with the alliances that were created, in order to help them understand why Australia needed to support Britain in World War I.

Background

World War I occurred due to the strength of alliances across Europe. Australia's alliance with Britain meant that it also became involved. Viewpoints on Australia's involvement in World War I differ. This unit helps students to identify and analyse these perspectives.

Starter activity

Remind students about the Triple Alliance and the Triple Entente. Ask students how these alliances could lead to World War I, and encourage them to consider how war could be declared in practice. Students could consider the following questions:

- Who declares a war?
- Does being part of an alliance force you to join a war?
- Who declares a war first?

Discuss Australia's links to Britain and its consequent interest in the events of World War I despite its distance from Europe.

Resource and Activity sheets

In the first Activity sheet, 'Mapping the declaration of war', students place declarations of war into the order in which they occurred.

The Resource sheet, 'Should Australia get involved?', offers students an insight into the reasons Australia joined the fighting. Make sure students understand each reason before they progress to the next Activity sheet.

The second Activity sheet, 'Analysing viewpoints', encourages students to analyse different viewpoints, articulating the strengths and weaknesses of each.

In the Activity sheet, 'Arguing a viewpoint', students present their view of Australia's role in World War I as a structured persuasive argument. This should include a topic sentence, three reasons for their viewpoint and a conclusion.

The Activity sheet, 'Different perspectives', encourages students to consider the feelings of Australians from different backgrounds regarding Australia's role in World War I.

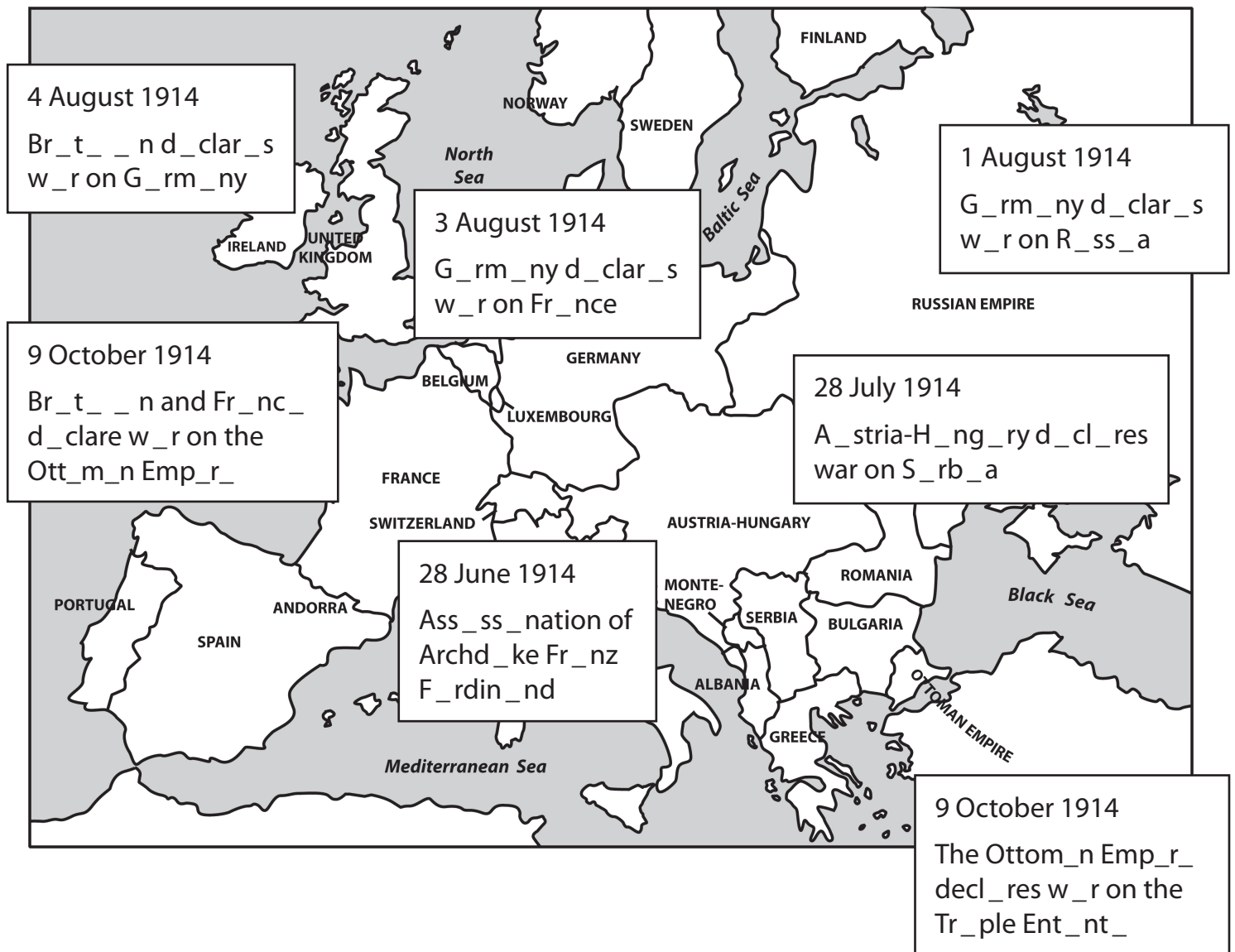
Extension ideas

- Students could adopt the profile of a particular country and explain why they went to war, either by giving an oral presentation or writing a journal entry from the perspective of that country's leader.

Mapping the declaration of war

When one country wants to fight another, they **declare** war against them. The trigger for World War I was the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand. This led Austria-Hungary to declare war on Serbia. Germany and Austria-Hungary were allies. This means that when Austria-Hungary declared war against Serbia, Germany had to do the same.

 1 Fill in the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to complete the labels on the map.



Should Australia get involved?

Britain declared war on Germany on 4 August 1914. The British Empire had many colonies. When Britain entered the war, its colonies and former colonies felt they needed to defend their ally.

Australia was a former colony of Britain, and one its allies. Many Australians felt that it was their duty (job) to defend Britain when it needed support in World War I.

However, not everyone agreed that Australia should join the fighting. Each side had reasons for their viewpoint (opinion).

Should Australia go to war?

YES

We should go to war because ...

- 1 Many of us came from Britain. We should help defend the 'mother country'.
- 2 We need to help defend our ally.
- 3 We are still part of the British Empire, so we need to do our bit.
- 4 Britain's King is Australia's King – we have a duty to fight for King and country.
- 5 The war will soon be over.
- 6 We need to fight against the Germans who invaded Belgium.

NO

We should NOT go to war because ...

- 1 Australia is not in Europe – the fight does not affect us.
- 2 Australia is no longer a colony of Britain.
- 3 It will cost lots of money.
- 4 It will cost many lives.
- 5 It is wrong to kill other people.
- 6 Australia should look to the future and not be bound by the past.

Analysing viewpoints

People see things differently. It is important to consider other viewpoints as well as your own. Each viewpoint has both strengths and weaknesses.

 Identify one strength and one weakness of each of the following viewpoints. Some have been completed for you.

- 1 Many of us came from Britain. We should help defend the 'mother country'.
 - a Weakness: Not everyone is from Britain ***This is why I don't find this persuasive***
 - b Strength: Who would not defend their mother? ***This is why I find this persuasive***
- 2 Australia is not in Europe – the fight does not affect us.
 - a Weakness: Australia is still linked to Britain through the British Empire.
 - b Strength: _____
- 3 We need to help defend our ally.
 - a Weakness:
 - b Strength: You should defend a friend.
- 4 Australia is no longer a colony of Britain.
 - a Weakness: Britain and Australia are still part of the same empire.
 - b Strength: _____
- 5 We are still part of the British Empire, so we need to do our bit.
 - a Weakness: Britain has many other allies who can help them – they don't need us.
 - b Strength: _____
- 6 It will cost lots of money.
 - a Weakness: _____
 - b Strength: We could spend our money helping Australians – not wasting it on guns to kill people.

Arguing a viewpoint

When people have different viewpoints, they often get into arguments about who is correct. In order to win these arguments, they must give clear reasons why they believe that their viewpoint is correct.



1 Circle whether you agree or disagree with the following viewpoint:

Australia should join World War I

AGREE

DISAGREE

2 Write three reasons for your viewpoint. HINT: Look back at the arguments on the Activity sheet, 'Analysing viewpoints'.

- _____
- _____
- _____

In order to express your viewpoint persuasively, you need to be able to summarise what you believe and why you believe it.

3 Use the sentence starters to develop the arguments you listed above and create a summary of your viewpoint.

I believe that Australia _____

The first reason for my viewpoint is _____

My second reason is _____

My third and final reason for my viewpoint is _____

In conclusion, I believe that Australia _____

Different perspectives

‘Australians will stand beside our own to help and defend her to our last man and our last shilling.’

– Andrew Fisher, 31 July 1914. He became Prime Minister of Australia one month later.

This statement was made by Andrew Fisher, Labor leader in the Australian Parliament at the time. He made the speech during his campaign to become Prime Minister, which he won. Although many Australians agreed with him, some people had different viewpoints.

- 1 Select three emotions in the word bank to describe how each person would be feeling as Australia was deciding whether to join in the fighting.
- 2 Use the words you have chosen to write a sentence describing how each person was feeling. The first one has been done for you.

Viewpoint	I feel ...
 You are a 20-year-old man, bored in your current job and looking for an adventure.	I feel excited , enthusiastic and eager .
 You are a mother with two sons who are both old enough to fight in the war.	
 You are a 40-year-old man who fought in the Boer War (1899–1902) in South Africa and saw soldiers killed in front of you.	
 You are a young German man living in Australia. You are old enough to fight for the Germans in a war.	

Word bank

upset
 excited
 concerned
 troubled
 enthusiastic
 angry
 offended
 menaced
 eager
 disappointed
 anxious
 interested
 worried
 involved
 annoyed
 panicked
 fearful
 alarmed
 scared
 tearful

Objectives

- To understand the use of propaganda
- To identify the reasons why men enlisted
- To use different communication forms

Prior knowledge

Students should have an understanding of the causes of World War I and the reasons behind Australia's involvement. This will help them to understand why Australians were recruited for World War I.

Background

When Australia declared its support for Britain in World War I, it needed to recruit soldiers to join the fight. While there were age, height and fitness restrictions for soldiers joining the army in 1914, these were soon relaxed as the death toll rose and the number of men enlisting declined. The idea of conscription was introduced as a way of raising army numbers, and the issue was voted on by the Australian public in 1915 and 1917. While both referendums failed, the conscription debate divided Australian society.

Starter activity

Hold a class discussion about the reasons someone might choose to join the army. Ask students to consider the following questions, and write a personal response.

- Would you join the army?
- Would you kill for your country?
- Would you die for your country?

Students should review their response at the end of the unit to see if their opinion has changed once they have a better understanding of recruitment.

Resource and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet, 'Who joins the war?', informs students of the numbers of Australians who joined World War I. Students then analyse the extent of the initial Australian war effort.

The second Activity sheet, 'Recruitment advertisements (1)', provides an example of a recruitment advertisement that employs the strategy of using a well-known soldier to encourage sportsmen to join the Australian army. The poster depicts

Lieutenant Albert Jacka, VC, the first Australian to win the Victorian Cross during World War I. Students examine the use of propaganda by answering literal, inferential and evaluative questions about the advertisement.

The Activity sheet, 'Recruitment advertisements (2)', continues the analysis of recruitment advertisements, focusing on the negative links drawn between the prospect of losing the war and having Germany dominate the world. Literal, inferential and evaluative questions build on the previous activity, enabling students to analyse and understand propaganda.

The Resource sheet, 'The conscription debate (1)', introduces the idea of conscription and explains how the practice was almost introduced in Australia during World War I. Students analyse the issue in the Activity sheet, 'The conscription debate (2)', exploring reasons for and against conscription before forming their own opinion and constructing an argument to express this.

Extension ideas

- Students could create their own World War I Australian recruitment advertisement. This should appeal to eligible men and tap into their emotions in order to persuade them to enlist.
- Students could research Lieutenant Albert Jacka, VC, and create a poster presenting information about his career and achievements.

Who joins the war?

When war broke out in Europe, men rushed to **enlist** (join) in the war across Europe and its colonies. Only men could enlist as soldiers and go to war. Women could only participate by working as nurses or providing support away from the battlefield.

Australia joined the fighting in August 1914, and men were keen to enlist. The Australian army chose its best men to fight in Europe, and by the end of 1914 more than 50 000 men had enlisted. The army had high standards – men had to meet strict age, height and fitness requirements in order to join. This meant that thousands of men were rejected by the Australian military (army).



Australian soldiers on a recruitment drive.
Courtesy, Australian War Memorial H11585.

Australia had a population of four million people by the beginning of 1914. From the 820 000 who were the right age to go to war, the army recruited 50 000 of Australia's best men to join the fight.

 **1** How many men had joined the Australian army by the end of 1914?

2 The photo refers to a 'fit man'. What do you think a fit man is?

3 Why were some men turned away from the army? _____

4 Do you think men should have been turned away from the army? Why do you believe this? _____

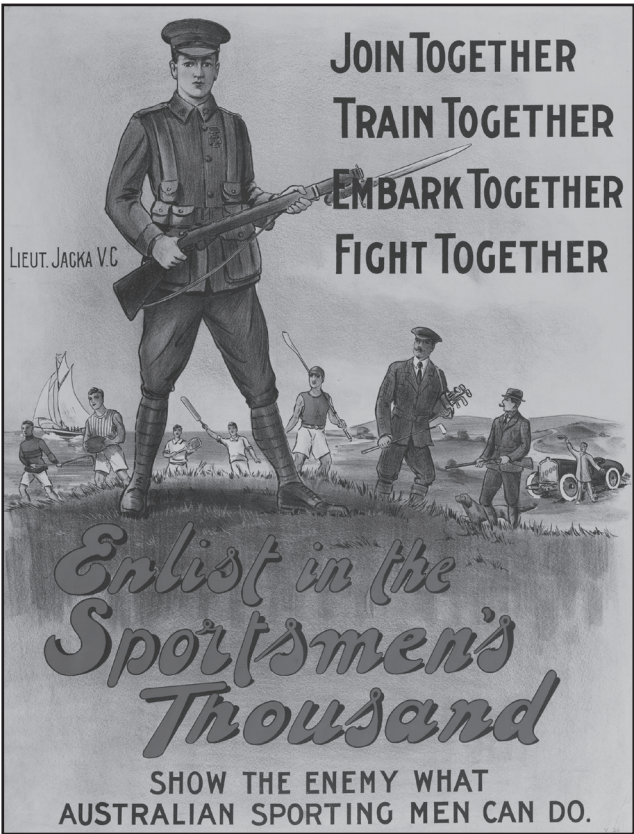
Recruitment advertisements (1)

Recruitment advertisements were produced to persuade Australian men to join the army. These advertisements were made to persuade Australians to join the war, so they only showed the positive things about World War I. They did not show the horrible realities of war. This is called **propaganda**. The recruitment advertisements on this page and the next page are examples of propaganda.

-  1 What four actions do soldiers do together? Why do you think these actions were listed on the poster?

- 2 What does the poster tell you about World War I?

- 3 Would this poster convince you to join World War I? Why/why not?



This poster, *Enlist in the Sportsmen's Thousand*, artist unknown, 1917, depicts Lieutenant Albert Jacka, VC, as a role model for a campaign to enlist sportsmen into the Australian Imperial Force. Courtesy, Australian War Memorial ARTV00026.

Recruitment advertisements (2)

 Read the Activity sheet 'Recruitment advertisements (1)', then complete the following questions about this advertisement.

1 What is the monster crushing?

2 The poster is made for Australians to look at. How are they meant to feel towards the monster?

3 Who do you think the monster represents? Why do you believe this?

4 The monster is spilling blood. Why is the blood moving towards Australia?

5 Do you think this would make Australians want to join the war? Why do you believe this?



This poster, called '?', was drawn by Norman Lindsay in 1918. Courtesy, Australian War Memorial ARTV00078.

The conscription debate (1)

There were a lot of reasons why Australian men wanted to join the army in 1914. These included:

- Men got paid to be soldiers.
- Everyone thought the war would be over in six weeks, so they'd be home by Christmas.
- It was a chance to go on an adventure.
- It was an opportunity to travel for free.
- Being a soldier was a way that men could support their King and country.
- Peer pressure – all their mates were signing up.

Australia joined the war in August 1914. By the end of the year, 50 000 Australians had joined the war. That meant that more than 10 000 men signed up each month. However, by April 1915 the number of men enlisting each month had dropped to 6000.

In April 1915 Australian troops were fighting at Gallipoli in Turkey (Ottoman Empire). Many Australians were killed at Gallipoli. The Australian army needed new soldiers to replace those they had lost and keep their numbers strong. In July 1915 they made it easier to join the army by reducing the height and age limits. The change is shown below.

	Minimum height	Age limit
August 1914	168 cm (5 feet 6 inches)	19–38
July 1915	157 cm (5 feet 2 inches)	18–45

Some people believed that men should be forced to join the war. This would mean that all men of the right age could be forced to sign up. This is called **conscription**.

Australians had to vote on the idea of introducing conscription. Debates were held, where people argued for and against conscription. There were two public votes – one in 1915 and one in 1917.

Australians were divided almost equally on the issue of conscription, and both votes were very close. However, the majority of Australians valued the freedom for men to choose whether or not to go to war, and both votes failed. Conscription was not introduced, and joining World War I remained a choice for Australian men.

The conscription debate (2)

Some people argued for conscription and others argued against it. Below are some of the arguments for each side of the debate.

FOR CONSCRIPTION	AGAINST CONSCRIPTION
• Australia needs more soldiers • Everyone needs to do their fair share (of fighting) • Britain needs more Australian troops – Australia needs to show loyalty to Britain • Britain, the mother country, introduced conscription. Australia should follow their example. • If you vote against conscription, you are helping the Germans to win the war, as we will have less soldiers to fight them with • If Germany wins the war they will take over Australia • If the army is not strong then more soldiers will be killed	• No one should be forced to see the horrors of war (death) • You cannot force people to fight if they don't want to • Voting yes means sending someone to war and probably to their death • Forcing people to fight when they don't want to be there will weaken the army • Too many Australian men have already been killed in World War I • The war does not directly involve Australia so we cannot force people to give their lives to fight

 **1** Are you for or against conscription in World War I? (Circle your chosen opinion.)

FOR

AGAINST

2 Which three reasons do you find most persuasive?

- _____
- _____
- _____

Objectives

- To understand the use of propaganda
- To understand primary and secondary sources
- To process and blend information from a range of sources as evidence for an argument

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge to complete this unit.

Background

Nations used propaganda to win the hearts and minds of the people, convincing them of the benefits of war. This meant people were willing to serve in the armies and make sacrifices for the war effort. The use of propaganda in World War I was crucial in enabling countries to sustain contributions to the war effort.

Starter activity

Ask students to persuade you to not give homework to the class. After hearing their arguments, ask students to consider whether they were balanced. Encourage them to consider how removing a balanced perspective increases the persuasiveness of the viewpoint being presented. Get students thinking about modern examples of propaganda, such as product advertisements or political propaganda during election campaigns.

Resource and Activity sheets

The first Activity sheet, 'Defining propaganda', introduces students to the term 'propaganda' and addresses the importance of its use in World War I.

The second Activity sheet, 'Sources of propaganda', introduces primary and secondary sources, linking them to sources of propaganda, both from World War I and the material that was written about it after the event.

The Activity sheet, 'Evaluation of propaganda: Primary sources', asks students to evaluate primary sources, identifying the origin, purpose and context of each source.

The Activity sheet, 'Evaluation of propaganda: Secondary sources', asks students to evaluate secondary sources, again identifying the origin, purpose and context of each.

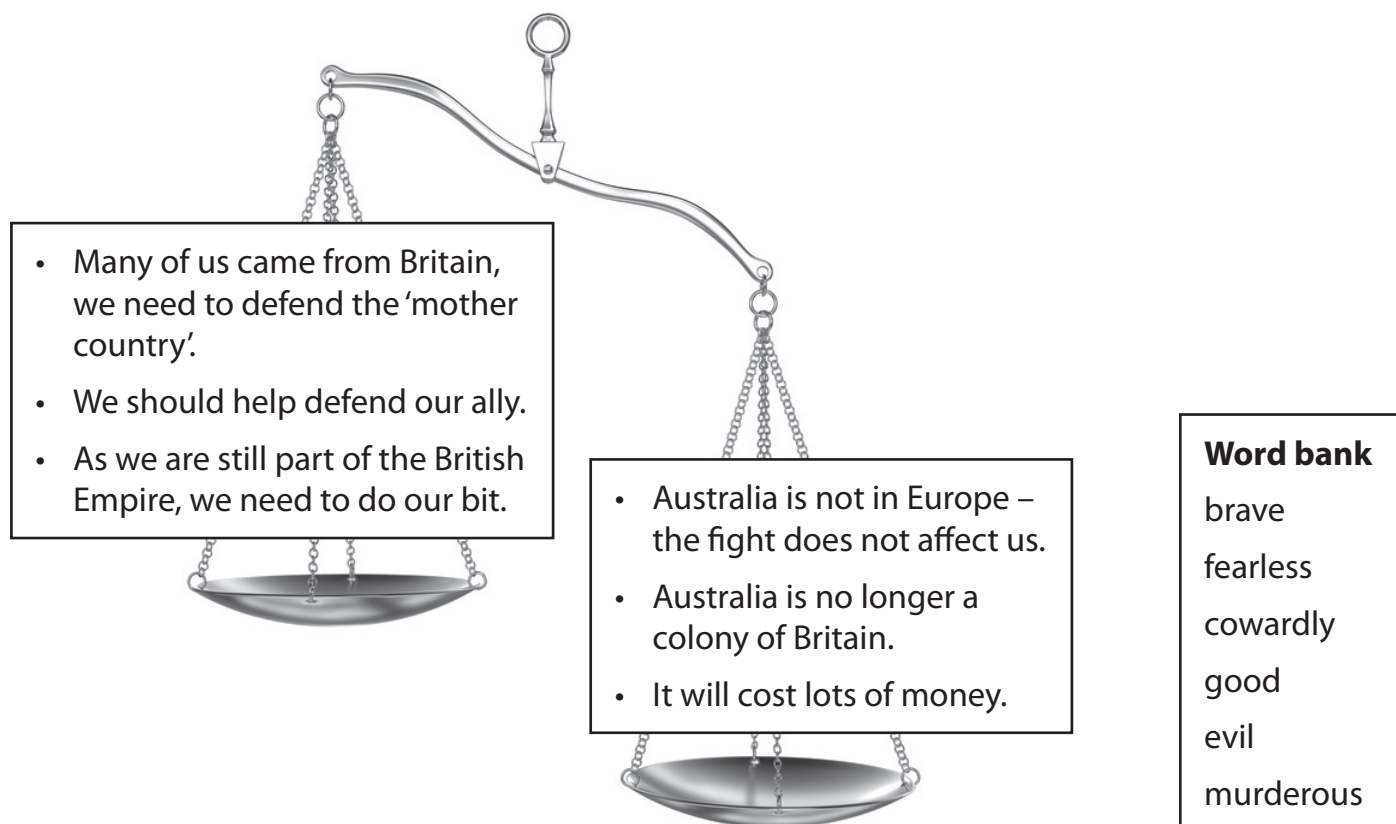
The Activity sheet, 'Using propaganda as evidence', asks students to present their perspective on an issue, using primary and secondary sources to support their argument.

Extension ideas

- After completing the Activity sheet, 'Using propaganda as evidence', students could write their opinion as an essay, using full sentences and paragraphs.
- To further develop their public speaking skills, students could then give an oral presentation to the class, expressing their point of view and explaining how the source supports it. Students could use digital technology such as PowerPoint or Prezi, if available.

Defining propaganda

Propaganda is information used to support a single point of view. This is called presenting a **biased** or **unbalanced** viewpoint. Here are two opposing, unbalanced viewpoints of Australia's involvement in World War I:



Propaganda uses **persuasive language** to persuade the reader to agree with its point of view. Propaganda during World War I was designed to make people love their country and hate the enemy.

-  **1** Sort the words in the word bank into 'my country' and 'enemy country' to show how you would use persuasive language to help the war effort.

My country	Enemy country

Sources of propaganda

Propaganda was used in many things, including posters, songs and leaflets. We call these **sources** of propaganda.

Sources tell us more about history. Sources of information from World War I tell us more about the war, and about the propaganda that was used during the war.

There are two types of sources – primary sources and secondary sources.

	Primary sources	Secondary sources
When was it created?	when the event happened (during World War I)	after the event happened (after World War I)
Who created it?	someone alive at the time of the event	someone alive after the time of the event
How was the opinion formed?	by living through the event and experiencing it	by reading primary sources about the event
Examples are ...	artwork, diaries, letters, poems, posters, films and newspapers	history textbooks, statues, memorials, films about history, art about history

-  1 Tick the boxes below to show whether each source is a primary or secondary source.

Source	Primary	Secondary
Recruitment poster for the British army in 1914		
Song written about World War I in 2003		
Diary entry written by an Australian citizen, dated 19 April, 1916		
Photograph of World War I trenches taken in France, 1917		
Photograph of World War I trenches taken in France, 1997		
Newspaper article about World War I, written by the grandchildren of World War I soldiers		

Evaluation of propaganda: Primary sources

In order to learn from a source we need to evaluate it. This means understanding why it was created and what information it tells us.

Source 1 <i>Fighting the Kaiser, fighting the Kaiser, Who'll come a-fighting the Kaiser with me? And we'll drink all his beer, And eat up all his sausages, Who'll come a-fighting the Kaiser with me!</i>	Origin: Song sung by Australian soldiers during World War I Purpose: To keep up the spirits of soldiers by mocking the German enemy and to convince other Australian men to join them in the army Context: Australians were fighting against the Germans during World War I. The song is sung to the tune of 'Waltzing Matilda', linking World War I with the classic Australian song.
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 1 Complete the table about the primary source above.

What is the source?	
When was the source made?	
What is the purpose of the source?	
What was happening when the source was created (<i>the context</i>)?	
What does the source tell us about World War I?	

Evaluation of propaganda: Secondary sources

While primary sources show what happened during World War I, secondary sources were made after the war. We need to understand why these were created and what they tell us about World War I.

Source 2 <i>'The Gallipoli conflict is a good example of how propaganda aims were fulfilled for different nations. In Australia, newspapers celebrated the heroism of the men in the landing rather than dwelling on the 10 000 casualties in the first few months.'</i> Source: State Library of Victoria 2013, <http://ergo.slv.vic.gov.au/explore-history/australia-wwi/home-wwi/propaganda>	Origin: From an article on the website of the State Library of Victoria Purpose: To inform Australian school students about World War I propaganda and how it affected Australians Context: Australians were affected by propaganda that took a certain viewpoint of Australia's participation in World War I.
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 **1** Complete the table about the secondary sources above.

What is the source?	
When was the source made?	
What is the purpose of the source?	
What was happening when the source was created (<i>the context</i>)?	
What does the source tell us about World War I?	

Using propaganda as evidence

Propaganda sources can be used to support your viewpoint. We call this providing **evidence**.

-  **1** Consider the following question, then give your opinion. Provide evidence from the propaganda sources shown on the Activity sheets, 'Evaluation of propaganda: Primary sources' and 'Evaluation of propaganda: Secondary sources'. Fill out the table below with your response.

Question: Did Australian soldiers help win World War I?

Viewpoint statement

I believe that Australian soldiers ...

Source 1 evidence

The evidence from source 1 shows ...

This source supports my opinion because ...

Source 2 evidence

The evidence from source 2 shows ...

This source supports my opinion because ...

Objectives

- To investigate and understand the Anzac tradition
- To understand different perspectives
- To identify parts of the world that were involved in, or affected by, World War I

Prior knowledge

Students should be aware that the Australian army fought in World War I and understand why Australia joined the war.

Background

The Anzac legend was born from Australia's experiences in World War I. The term Anzac originally stood for Australian and New Zealand Army Corps, but by 1917 it referenced the men who fought at Gallipoli in World War I. Although it has since been used to describe all Australians killed in battle, it was during World War I that the courage, mateship and sacrifice of the Anzac legend was created. This is why we celebrate those qualities demonstrated by soldiers at Gallipoli each year on 25 April at dawn – the time and date of the Gallipoli landing. This unit teaches students about the men behind the Anzac legend.

Starter activity

Ask students where they have seen the word Anzac before. Show students Gallipoli on a map from 1914 and on a map from the present day. Explain that in 1914 Gallipoli was part of the Ottoman Empire, which had an alliance with Germany. This will clarify why the Anzacs fought in this region in World War I.

Introduce the topic of Anzac Day, which is observed on 25 April every year in Australia, and ask students to describe what they see, do and think about on the day.

Resource and Activity sheets

The first Resource sheet, 'Biographies of Anzacs (1)', outlines the background of Australian soldiers in World War I, helping students understand what motivated them to fight in the war. A biography of a soldier who fought in World War I is also provided.

The second Resource sheet, 'Biographies of Anzacs (2)', offers further insight into different perspectives of the many Australians involved in World War I.

The Activity sheet, 'Biographies of Anzacs – Analysis', asks students to investigate and analyse the individual perspectives of Australian soldiers.

In the Activity sheet, 'Biographies of Anzacs – Comparison', students choose two of the four viewpoints presented in the Resource sheets, then complete a Venn diagram to compare the perspectives. Students then articulate the similarities and differences in full sentences, using information from the Venn diagram.

The Activity sheet, 'Where Australians fought in World War I', outlines where Australians were stationed so students get a sense of how far the soldiers were from home, and how this affected their perspective of the fighting.

Extension ideas

Having mapped the places where Australians fought in World War I, students could explore the extent of the fighting by shading the map according to colonial ties, assigning a colour to each empire.

Additionally students could also investigate one of the countries Australians fought in. The following questions could form the basis of their investigation:

- What climate (weather) do these countries have?
- Look at the country on a world map. How far away from Australia is it?
- How did Australian soldiers travel to the country?
- How long did it take them to get there?
- How would an Australian soldier feel after this journey?
- Would you feel well-rested and ready to fight?

Biographies of Anzacs (1)

The **Anzacs** were the **A**ustralian and **N**ew **Z**ealand **A**rm**y** **C**orps. All the men were volunteers who chose to go to war. Some even lied about their age so they could join the fight.

The Anzacs' first major battle was the landing at Gallipoli in Turkey (Ottoman Empire) on 25 April 1915. They had to jump off boats and run onto the beaches. They were running into a strange environment, wearing full military uniform. In these difficult conditions Australians quickly gained a toughness, or **resilience**.

The Anzac troops quickly developed a reputation as soldiers who looked out for their mates, were brave and willing to sacrifice their lives to defend Australia and the British Empire.

Anzacs who fought in World War I came from many different backgrounds, and joined the war for different reasons. The biographies of soldiers can help us to understand their different experiences.

Biography of an Indigenous Australian

Albert Knight (1894–1973)

Albert Knight was born in March 1894 on Toorale station near Louth, New South Wales. He joined the Australian Imperial Force in November 1914, the second of three brothers to fight in World War I.

Albert served in Belgium, where he was a bombing specialist and a noted scout. He stepped on a bomb in May 1918, but returned to the war after recovering from his injuries. In September 1918 he advanced 183 m across the battlefield in broad daylight, found the enemy's weapons and destroyed them. This won him the Victoria Cross.

He returned to Australia in July 1919 and went back to bush work in New South Wales, where he died in 1973.

Biographies of Anzacs (2)

Biography of an immigrant Australian

John Simpson Kirkpatrick (1892–1915)

John Simpson Kirkpatrick was born in Britain. He moved to Australia and joined the Australian Imperial Force in August 1914. He was killed in action on 19 May 1915, having taken part in the Gallipoli landing.

Simpson was a stretcher-bearer during the Gallipoli campaign. His job was to transport wounded soldiers using a donkey and working under sniper-gun fire. He was killed while carrying two wounded men under machine-gun fire.

Biography of a young Australian-born soldier

Jim Martin (1901–1915)

Jim Martin was born in the same year that Australia became an independent country. He went to war out of a sense of duty.

He landed at Gallipoli in October and immediately became sick because of the poor hygiene and terrible conditions. He was taken to a hospital ship, but died and was buried at sea. He was 14. The official joining age was 18.

Biography of an Australian army nurse

Clare Deacon (1891–1952)

Clare Deacon was born on 13 March 1891 at Pipers River, Tasmania. She was the daughter of a farmer.

Clare trained as a nurse at Hobart Hospital and passed her general nursing exam in 1912. She enlisted in the Australian Imperial Force in 1914, and was deployed as a staff nurse in the Army Nursing Service. She was posted to Egypt and served at Mena during the Gallipoli campaign.

Clare worked in France from December 1915. She was awarded the Military Medal for bravery under fire after running into a bombed hospital building and getting the patients to safety, risking her life in the process. She returned to Australia in 1918, where she died of meningitis in 1952.

Biographies of Anzacs – Analysis

In order to properly understand the information we read, we need to analyse what is being said. This includes re-reading the text to find particular information.

-  **1** Read the Resource sheets, 'Biographies of Anzacs (1) and (2)'. Use the information in the biographies to complete the table below.

	Jim Martin	John Simpson Kirkpatrick	Albert Knight	Clare Deacon
Where were they born?				
What was their job in World War I?				
Where did they die?				
How old were they when they died?				
Where did they fight during World War I?				
What was their biggest achievement in World War I?				
What makes this person's biography different to the others?				

Biographies of Anzacs – Comparison

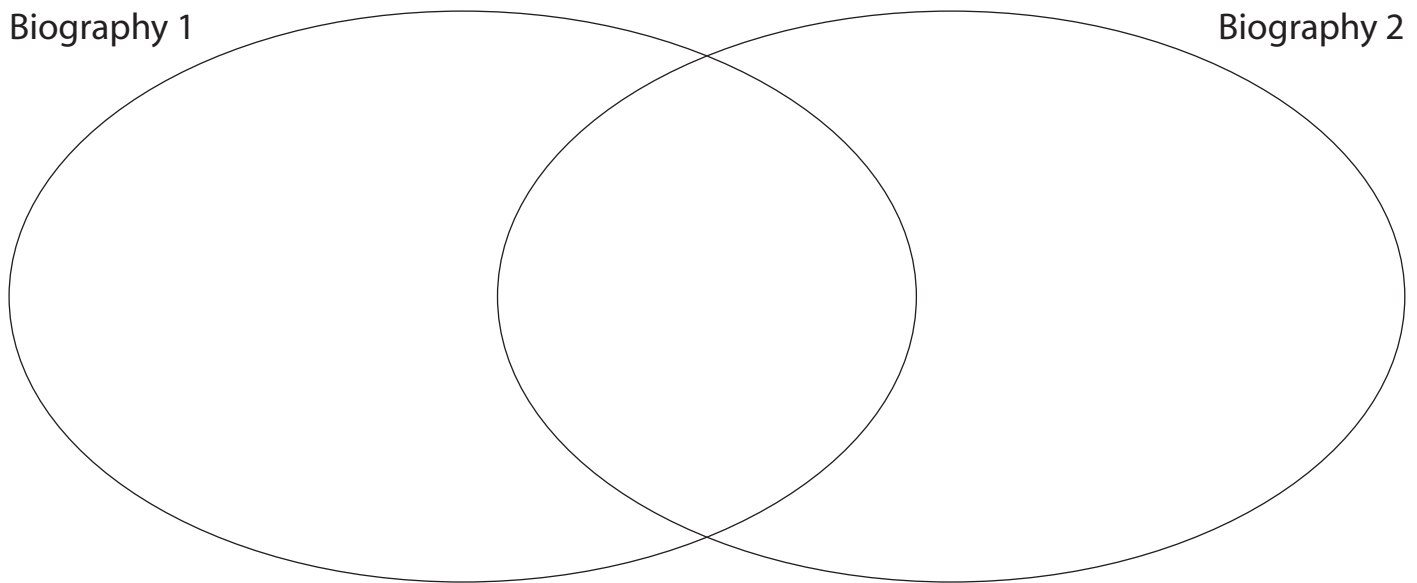
The Anzacs who fought in World War I all had different experiences. In order to compare these experiences, you first need to identify the similarities and differences between them.



- 1 Choose two of the perspectives presented on the Activity sheet, 'Biographies of Anzacs – Analysis', and use the information to fill in the Venn diagram below. Write the things they have in common (similarities) in the space where the circles overlap, and the differences in the separate parts of the circles.

Biography 1

Biography 2



- 2 What are the similarities between the Anzacs?

- 3 What are the differences between the Anzacs?

- 4 Are there more similarities or differences between the Anzacs?

- 5 Do you think the differences between the Anzacs would have mattered during the war?

Where Australians fought in World War I

When Australians joined World War I they were fighting as part of the British Empire, which spanned a quarter of the world's surface and controlled a third of the world's resources. The British Empire was allied with the French and Russian empires, and was also fighting against the empires of Germany, Austria-Hungary and the Ottoman (Turkey).

Most battles were fought away from Britain and Germany, in countries such as France and Turkey. This was to ensure that if they lost a battle, their home territory would not be taken over. Australians fighting in World War I were sent to different locations all around the world. The graves and memorials for the Anzacs who fought in these places are still there today.

-  Colour in the places where Australians fought in World War I on the map below. Look up the countries in an atlas if you cannot find them on the map.



Locations Australians fought and died in during World War I:

Turkey	New Guinea	United Kingdom	Greece
Egypt	France	Belgium	Syria
Germany	Palestine	Lebanon	

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